

The Noble Teaching on the Inconceivable Qualities of the Dharma of the Buddhas

Ārya-buddha-dharma-acintya-nirdeśa · Toh 187 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སངས་རྒྱལ་གྱི་ཆོས་བསམ་གསུམ་ཁིལ་པ་བསྒྲུབ།

The Noble Teaching on the Inconceivable Qualities of the Dharma of the Buddhas, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-buddha-dharma-acintya-nirdeśa and in Tibetan as Phags pa sangs rgyas kyi chos bsam gyis mi khyab pa bstan pa, is a Mahāyāna sūtra exploring the inconceivable and transcendent qualities of the buddhas and their dharma. The text unfolds as a teaching prompted by the reflections of a great assembly of bodhisattvas, each contemplating a different aspect of the buddhas' inexhaustible qualities — from their purified buddha-fields and aspirations to their lineage, arising, and bodies — suggesting a wide-ranging meditation on the nature of awakening that lies beyond ordinary conceptual grasp. It belongs to the genre of discourses in which the wonders of the buddhas serve as the occasion for doctrinal elaboration directed at the bodhisattva path. This text is Toh 187 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the Mahāyāna sūtras.

In the language of India: Ārya-buddha-dharma-acintya-nirdeśa. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Teaching on the Inconceivable Qualities of the Dharma of the Buddhas. First section.

Homage to the assembly of buddhas and the many bodhisattvas.

Then, from among the many bodhisattvas gathered there, certain bodhisattvas gave rise to various thoughts. Some thought: "The buddha-fields of the blessed buddhas are inconceivable." Others thought: "The purified aspirations born from the previous prayers of the blessed buddhas are inconceivable." Others thought: "The lineage of the Tathāgatas belonging to the blessed buddhas is inconceivable." Others thought: "The arising of the buddhas among the blessed ones is inconceivable." Others thought: "The body of the Tathāgata belonging to the blessed buddhas is inconceivable." Others thought: "The voice of the Tathāgata belonging to the blessed buddhas is inconceivable." Others thought: "The primordial wisdom of the Tathāgata belonging to the blessed buddhas is inconceivable." Others thought: "The emanations of the Tathāgata belonging to the blessed buddhas are inconceivable." Others thought: "The conduct free from attachment of the blessed buddhas is inconceivable." And others thought: "The liberation of the

buddhas among the blessed ones is inconceivable."

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the thoughts arising in the minds of those bodhisattvas, blessed the bodhisattva Utpalahṛdaya with the blessing of the buddha's blessing power. Through this, that bodhisattva entered into the flow of the buddha's primordial wisdom; he became illuminated by the radiance of the Tathāgata; he became permeated throughout with the splendor of the buddha; he came to abide in the fearlessness of the buddha; he came to be endowed with the entry into and the flowing-forth within the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, of the buddhas; he entered into that domain through the greatness and the miraculous powers of the buddhas; he came to abide in the ten-fold conduct free from attachment and free from obstruction; he came to know exclusively, one after another, the lineage of all the buddhas; and he came to engage in and accomplish the ways of the Dharma of the buddhas, which are beyond telling.

Then the bodhisattva Utpalahṛdaya, having fully understood and realized the entry into the dharmadhātu, accomplished it within the domain of a mind free from attachment. Through the conduct of a bodhisattva, he abandoned the obscurations of all phenomena; he entered into and was endowed with the aspiration of Samantabhadra; he fully understood all the buddhas and beheld the buddhas; he donned the great armor of great compassion and gazed upon all sentient beings, purifying them completely; he established the maṇḍala of the sacred commitments of the conduct of all bodhisattvas; he reached the furthest limit of moments; he manifestly accomplished the primordial wisdom of the buddhas; he beheld the inexhaustible; he was to make omniscience directly present; all dhāraṇīs became manifest to him; and having realized the four correct and individual knowledges, the bodhisattva Utpalahṛdaya then, through the power of the buddhas, spoke thus to the bodhisattva Padmahṛdaya:

"O son of the Victors, the conduct of the blessed buddhas is immeasurable! O son of the Victors, the blessed buddhas abide in great emanation! O son of the Victors, the activities of all the marks of the body of the blessed buddhas have been fully acquired! The blessed buddhas, endowed with the intention of meditative absorption, turn the wheel of Dharma. The blessed buddhas demonstrate the four correct and individual knowledges in a manner beyond all expression."

The blessed buddhas abide in the inconceivable Dharma of all the blessed buddhas. The blessed buddhas send forth immeasurable buddha voice and melody. The blessed buddhas realize and penetrate the inexpressible dharmadhātu. The blessed buddhas are the supreme sovereign among all superknowledges, fully awakened.

O son of the Victors, in brief, the blessed buddhas enter into the boundless expanse of the dharmadhātu, free from all obscuration at its edges. O son of the Victors, the dharmadhātu of the blessed buddhas is without edge or center.

There are ten qualities of a buddha. What are these ten?

The form body of the blessed buddhas, being without edge or center, is perfectly pure and unstained, having abandoned all wandering about. The blessed buddhas, through the eye of non-attachment toward all phenomena, which is without edge or center, attain fully manifest awakening in the very evenness of that eye. The blessed buddhas, through the ear of non-attachment, which is without edge or center, hear without obstruction the sounds of all beings. The blessed buddhas, through the sense base of the nose, which is without edge or center, have attained supreme dominion over all buddhas. The blessed buddhas, through the tongue of the Blessed One, vast and subtle, without edge or center, move through the voice and melody of the entire expanse of all phenomena. The blessed buddhas, through the body without edge or center, exhausting without remainder all residues of karma, display and make accessible the Tathāgata in the mindstreams of all sentient beings throughout every realm of sentient beings. The blessed buddhas, through the mental action without edge or center, inseparable from the dharmakāya and not attached to the three times, follow in a course of pure activity. The blessed buddhas, abiding in the liberation of a buddha, without edge or center, display inexhaustible buddha emanations and miraculous displays. The blessed buddhas, through the perfect purity of every world-realm, without edge or center, bestow blessings of inexpressible adornment and display, just as intended, the pure buddha-fields free of affliction. The blessed buddhas fully awaken to all phenomena through the distinctive conduct of all bodhisattvas, the perfect completion of aspirations, the sport of primordial wisdom, the perfection of Dharma, and the perfection of the Dharma of the sport of primordial wisdom.

O son of the Victors, these are the ten qualities of a buddha that belong to the dharmadhātu without edge or center of the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas.

O son of the Victors, the blessed buddhas display ten characteristics by which the defining marks of buddha wisdom are fully accomplished. What are these ten?

In a single instant, they display passing away from the Tuṣita heaven in every world-realm. In a single instant, they display the bodhisattva life in every world-realm. In a single instant, they display taking birth in every world-realm. In a single instant, they display sitting beneath the tree of awakening and attaining full manifest awakening in every world-realm. In a single instant, they display turning the wheel of Dharma in every world-realm.

In a single instant, they display in every world-realm the knowing of exactly when sentient beings are ripe and ready to be tamed, and the satisfying of them accordingly. In a single instant, they display in every world-realm the inconceivably varied forms of the Tathāgata's body, each appearing in accordance with how the sentient beings there are to be tamed. In a single instant, they display in every world-realm the treasury of the Tathāgata's omniscience — supreme among the noble ones, adorned with inconceivably varied ornaments. In a single instant, they display in every world-realm the complete purity of all things. In a single instant, they display in every world-realm the arising of the buddhas of past, present, and future; the graduated conduct practiced through varied faculties, diligence, and faith; and the direct knowledge of lineage by the buddhas of the three times.

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten characteristics by which the blessed buddhas display the defining marks of fully accomplishing buddha wisdom.

O sons of the Victor, the blessed buddhas have ten timings they never transgress. What are these ten?

The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, never transgress the time of attaining full manifest awakening. The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, never transgress the ripening — the karmic maturation of perfectly virtuous ripening. The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, give prophecies to bodhisattvas who are fully ripened. The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, display miracles in accordance with the intentions of sentient beings. The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, display the blessing of the buddha's body in accordance with the faith of sentient beings.

The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, abide in equanimity. The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, enter villages, towns, and cities. The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, accept those sentient beings who are thoroughly purified in mind. The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, tame without force those sentient beings who are afflicted and difficult to tame. The blessed buddhas, knowing the right time, display inconceivably varied emanations of the buddha.

O sons of the Victor, these are the timings from which the blessed buddhas never transgress.

O sons of the Victor, the blessed buddhas have ten domains that are unequalled and inconceivable. What are these ten?

With a single cross-legged seat, pervading all world-realms without exception. With a single verse at its root, perfectly revealing all buddhas. With a single ray of light, illuminating all world-realms without exception. With a single body, displaying all bodies. With a body that follows after all world-realms without exception, dwelling focused in one direction. With a single wisdom, penetrating all phenomena without obstruction. Knowing the right time, with a single arising of mind, pervading without remainder the expanse of all phenomena. Following after the immeasurable greatness of buddhahood, in a single step revealing suchness. Throughout all three times, pervading with the glorious splendor of buddha-fields. The buddhas, unlike all beings, move in a single essential nature of past, present, and future — acting in non-duality.

O Children of the Victor, these are the ten incomparable and inconceivable domains of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

O Children of the Victor, the Tathāgatas possess ten knowledges of accomplishment through the blessing of buddhahood. What are these ten? The knowledge of accomplishing aspirational prayers by engaging in all phenomena without abiding anywhere. The knowledge of accomplishing a body without a body. The knowledge of accomplishing the full and perfect awakening through the non-duality of all phenomena. The knowledge of accomplishing the taming of sentient beings while abiding in the ultimate truth of the selflessness of sentient beings. The knowledge of accomplishing the manifestation of diverse characteristics even though all phenomena are without characteristics. The knowledge of accomplishing the gathering and transformation of all world-realms and their objects without remainder. The knowledge of accomplishing the maturation of karma without grasping at any

object whatsoever. The knowledge of accomplishing all phenomena within the expanse that is inexpressible. The knowledge of accomplishing that which is neither defiled nor purified. And the knowledge of accomplishing the arising of characteristics of birth and arising, together with the assembly of conditions and combinations, even though all phenomena are without birth.

O Children of the Victor, these are the ten knowledges of accomplishment through the blessing of buddhahood possessed by the Tathāgatas.

O Children of the Victor, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess ten immeasurable attributes. What are these ten? Following after all three times is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Possessing the three miracles that tame all sentient beings is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Being skilled in the thorough analysis of the root of the buddha-Dharma, dhāraṇīs, and verses is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Possessing all turnings of the wheel of Dharma and the Tathāgata's four kinds of correct and thorough knowledge is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Never abandoning any sentient being through great compassion is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. At all times beholding all sentient beings and constantly benefiting them with equanimity is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Taming all sentient beings through the roots of virtue is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Abiding without attachment to the expanse of all phenomena is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. In a single moment, encompassing all the arising of buddhas of the past, future, and present is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. And in a single day following after and revealing all the kalpas of the three times is an attribute of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

O Children of the Victor, these are the ten immeasurable attributes of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

O Children of the Victor, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess ten supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellences of Dharma. What are these ten? Vanquishing and demolishing the assaults of Māra is the great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Utterly cutting through all adversaries who draw near on one side and all opposing forces on the other is a great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma. Taming and satisfying all sentient beings is a great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Going to all world-realms by virtue of the power to tame

sentient beings is a great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Thoroughly penetrating and knowing the expanse of Dharma is a great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

Following all world-realms without exception with a body that is non-dual, and manifesting the varied forms of a buddha's body — this is a great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, entering into the domain of the four kinds of precise knowledge through all the branches of melodious voice, and teaching those four kinds of precise knowledge, and taming through hearing sentient beings who are free of delusion and whose minds are clear — this is a great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones arising from every pore of the body — just as from a single pore — as many as the subtle dust-particles of all the elements of the body, and in like manner from every pore of a buddha's body bringing forth in succession sentient beings as numerous as the subtle dust-particles of all world-realms — this is a great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

A Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha displaying, within a single subtle dust-particle of his domain, buddha-fields as numerous as the subtle dust-particles of all world-realms; the adornments of those buddha-fields blazing forth by their very nature, turning the wheel of Dharma, taming sentient beings in an uninterrupted stream, and yet without sending anything forth, without harm, and without harm throughout all world-realms — without having enlarged that subtle dust-particle and without having diminished the world-realm — abiding having thoroughly realized and known the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena: this is a great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

The Tathāgata attaining complete and perfect awakening in a realm devoid of darkness, and then appearing luminously even within that which is accompanied by darkness; leading sentient beings to the state of the Dharma of the buddhas, which is free of obscuration and utterly free of dimness; and in that state following in accord with the ten powers of the Tathāgata, the Blessed One: this is the tenth great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellence of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

O son of the Victors, these are the ten great supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellences of Dharma of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, by which they overwhelm all others.

O son of the Victors, there are ten ways in which the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is in all respects blameless and utterly pure. What are these ten?

The greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is perfectly accomplished and in all respects utterly blameless and pure.

The supremely lofty lineage of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — surpassing all the buddha lineages of past, future, and present — is in all respects blameless and utterly pure, and the Tathāgata's lineage is pure.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, not abiding in consciousness, and the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who are the last among those yet to come — in all respects blameless and pure.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who have vanquished abiding in all phenomena and who conduct themselves without abiding in the three times — this is the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, blameless in all respects and utterly pure.

Because the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, take up nothing manifold, they are of a single adornment in nature — this is the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, blameless in all respects and utterly pure.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possessed of merit that is inexhaustible, abiding in the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, which is equal to the limits of the past and the limits of the future — endowed with this inexhaustible merit,

this is the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, blameless in all respects and utterly pure.

For the sake of taming sentient beings, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, abide without attachment throughout all world-systems, in boundless forms and colors. This is the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, blameless in all respects and utterly pure.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, having attained the four kinds of fearlessness, abide without anxiety, roar the lion's roar as the supreme of herds, crush their challengers like a great tiger, and teach the Dharma with a mind like blazing

fire. This is the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, blameless in all respects and utterly pure.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, passed into complete nirvāṇa inconceivably many and more than inconceivably many eons ago, and yet by means of many names rightly deployed they continue to purify the field of giving of sentient beings, exactly in accordance with their entry into the teaching. And for as long as that lasts, even those who passed into complete nirvāṇa long ago — the merit-field created by making offerings to the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, will never be exhausted. This is the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, blameless in all respects and utterly pure.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, though dwelling in world-systems inconceivably many and more than inconceivably many times more distant than all other world-systems, nevertheless, whenever a sentient being dwelling in this world-system mindfully recollects a buddha, the Blessed One, they cause their form body to appear before that being. This is the greatness of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, blameless in all respects and utterly pure.

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten greatnesses of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, blameless in all respects and utterly pure.

O sons of the Victor, the ten utter purities of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — what are the ten? The utter purity of the former aspirational prayers of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the holy conduct of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the moral discipline of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, which is pure and utterly pure, free from attachment; the fact that the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, utterly purely cause all sentient beings to emerge from the aggregates; the utter purity of the buddha-field of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the utter purity of the retinue of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the utter purity of the dharmakāya of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the purity and utter purity of the major marks and excellent minor marks of the form body of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the utter purity of the dharmakāya of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; and the utter purity of the unobscured aggregate of the gnosis of omniscience of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; and the utter purity of the supreme excellence attained by the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, in that they accomplish the liberation and the overcoming of all buddhas. O sons of the Victor, these are the ten utter purities of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

O sons of the Victor, at all times and throughout all world-systems and realms, there are ten activities of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. What are the ten? At

all times, revealing buddhas to sentient beings who have succeeded in mindfully recollecting a buddha; at all times, teaching the Dharma to sentient beings who are aware as sentient beings;

at all times, generating immeasurable roots of virtue in sentient beings whose minds are utterly purified with respect to the Buddha; at all times, causing sentient beings who have passed along the path of the unchanging Dharma to realize gnosis; at all times, never interrupting the activity of the buddha for all beings throughout their destinies; at all times, the Tathāgatas passing through all world-systems without attachment; at all times, never interrupting great compassion toward all sentient beings; at all times, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, abiding in emanation; at all times, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, abiding as manifold emanated buddhas; and at all times, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, abiding in the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, by the power of the buddhas. O sons of the Victor, these are the ten activities of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, present at all times throughout all world-systems and realms.

O sons of the Victor, there are ten inexhaustible oceans of wisdom of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. What are the ten? The inexhaustible ocean of wisdom of the body of the Tathāgata of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have attained immeasurable buddha activities; the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom of the domain of the buddha's vision of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom of the immeasurable and inconceivable roots of virtue of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, cause the rain of all Dharmas to fall; the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom of the buddha qualities and the radiant colors of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom through which the omniscient buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have engaged in aspirational prayer from the beginning of time; the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, never interrupt buddha activity for all beings unto the final end of time; the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom of the conduct of the minds of all classes of sentient beings without exception of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; and the inexhaustible ocean of wisdom of omniscience that is not overshadowed by merit of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. O sons of the Victor, these are the ten inexhaustible oceans of wisdom of the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened

buddhas.

O sons of the Victor, there are ten eyes of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. What are the ten? There is the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have gone beyond and arisen from all things; the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have no instance of not knowing any phenomenon; the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have great compassion toward all; the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are endowed with all ten of the immeasurable powers; the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have turned the unsurpassed wheel of Dharma; the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have entered upon the taming of all sentient beings; the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, cause all beings throughout their destinies to fully and perfectly awaken directly; the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, through their abiding, tame those sentient beings who are to be tamed; the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have mastery over the defining characteristics of Dharma that proceed in non-duality; and the eye that is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, having tamed sentient beings and caused them to ripen in such a way that

they have reached the limit of the domain of buddhas, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, demonstrate their complete passage into nirvāṇa. O children of the Victors, these are the ten buddha-eyes of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

O children of the Victors, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess ten gateways through which they demonstrate the boundless Dharma of buddhas. What are those ten? The gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, demonstrate the boundless element of sentient beings; the gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, demonstrate the boundless variety of conduct among sentient beings; the gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, demonstrate the boundless karmic maturation of all sentient beings; the gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, demonstrate the boundless bestowal of guidance upon all sentient beings; the gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, demonstrate the boundless diligence in attending to the element of sentient beings; the gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, present the boundless guidance setting forth the conduct of bodhisattvas; the gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, demonstrate the boundless arising, through aspiration, in accordance with the successive distinctions of the bodhisattva stages; the gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed

Ones, demonstrate the boundless gathering and transformation encompassing the entire element of sentient beings without remainder; the gateway through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, display the purely adorned buddha-fields in accordance with the intention and faith of bodhisattvas; and the gateway, boundless in the discriminating wisdom of all buddhas, through which all worlds throughout all world-systems, in the past, the future, and the present, in each and every one of those realms, where buddhas appear one after another through successive aeons, are gathered by the power of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, and made fully manifest. O children of the Victors, these are the ten gateways through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, demonstrate the boundless Dharma of buddhas.

O children of the Victors, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform ten buddha-deeds. What are those ten? The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through the display of their form body; the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through their speech; the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through grasping; the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through non-grasping; the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through earth, water, fire, and wind; the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through all objects that arise by virtue of objects, by means of their blessing; the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through their major marks; the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through the fashioning of buddha-fields; the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through the perfect purity of their buddha-fields; and the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform buddha-deeds for sentient beings even through utter silence. O children of the Victors, these are the ten buddha-deeds that the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, perform for sentient beings.

O children of the Victors, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess ten essential qualities of Dharma for sentient beings. What are those ten? Uninterrupted aspiration and firm aspiration, speaking of non-duality, and acting in accordance with whatever one has declared — this is the first essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

Striving earnestly in the conduct of a bodhisattva, never growing weary, advancing to the furthest end of future time, and completing the adornment of

all qualities — this is the second essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

Seeing even a single sentient being in an inexpressible, utterly inexpressible world-realm who is worthy of being tamed, one does not remain there but journeys to all world-realms without exception — this is the third essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

When the minds of sentient beings are distracted, great compassion is brought to bear equally upon them; and when the minds of sentient beings are utterly clear and serene, great compassion is equally brought to bear upon them — this is the fourth essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

A Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha neither has arisen nor has not arisen; yet from the moment one enters upon unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening until one actually and fully awakens to that unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, the awakening mind does not perish — this is the fifth essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

Gathering all roots of virtue and dedicating them to omniscience, while not acting for the sake of worldly concerns — this is the sixth essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

From the very first moment, one trains in the physical actions, verbal actions, and mental actions following in the wake of the buddha-conduct of all buddhas, dedicating everything to omniscience, and — rather than following the conduct of śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas — one fully and completely awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — this is the seventh essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

The boundless, all-pervading radiance, the illumination of all buddha-qualities, and this pure mind of a bodhisattva: all appearances, equally and without exception, are thereby brought to perfect completion in omniscience — this is the eighth essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

Abandoning all worldly pleasure, having no desire for worldly joy, and possessing aspirations unstained by any trace of the world, equally and without exception — endowed thereby with all the wellbeing of the world, one destroys all suffering and all conceptual elaboration is no more — this is the ninth essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

Through faith in the domain of buddhas, one arouses the mind of hardship and austerity. Striving to guard the lineage of all buddhas, one comes to

understand all the suffering of every class of beings through direct knowing, and reaches the ultimate limit culminating in the powers and the ten grounds — this is the tenth essential quality of Dharma for sentient beings.

O children of the Victors, these are the ten essential qualities of Dharma for sentient beings that the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess.

O children of the Victors, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess ten ways of acting without attachment. What are those ten? The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, journeying to every single world-realm without remainder — this is acting without attachment. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, dwelling in every single world-realm without remainder — this is acting without attachment. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, pacing, standing, and sitting in every single world-realm without remainder — this is acting without attachment. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, teaching the Dharma in every single world-realm without remainder — this is acting without attachment. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, going to all world-realms without remainder and going to the Tuṣita heaven — this is acting without attachment. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, encompassing all the dharmadhātu without remainder, together with the former limit of time and the latter limit of time —

acting without attachment to what is presently arising. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, going to assemblies of immeasurable retinues in every single world-realm without remainder — this is acting without attachment. Beholding the conduct of the minds of all sentient beings without remainder, and in a single instant of mind displaying the three miracles and taming sentient beings — this is acting without attachment. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, going in a single buddha-body to immeasurable, inconceivable places and performing the great conduct of a buddha — this is acting without attachment. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, going to immeasurable, inconceivable places and appearing as a Teacher to all immeasurable sentient beings as numerous as the dust-motes of countless worlds — this is acting without attachment. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, gathering within themselves the boundless totality of all Tathāgatas without remainder — this is acting without attachment. O sons of the Victor, these are the ten acts without attachment of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

O sons of the Victor, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have ten supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornments of the buddha-body. What are the ten?

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are adorned with the major marks and excellent minor marks of a buddha — this is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornment of the buddha-body.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are endowed with the sixty supreme and excellent branches of voice, and fully possessing the hundred and five branches of speech, are adorned by many hundreds and thousands of such qualities. With the utterly pure, boundless, and limitless branches of voice and inexpressible buddha-qualities, with words and letters of consummate clarity, and with great fearlessness — fearless and without timidity, they roar like a lion — causing all sentient beings throughout the entire dharmadhātu without remainder to hear, to perceive, and to know; and they rouse and tame sentient beings one by one according to their various aspirations and their various capacities. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornment of the speech of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

The mental activity of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is adorned by the ten powers, and all the buddhas are thoroughly resplendent in great meditative absorption and supremely adorned with the ornament of the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha. Their domain of activity is the domain free of attachment; they rest in the dharmadhātu and have attained all the branches of the buddha-qualities. They are the adornment of the entire dharmadhātu without remainder, and with a wisdom conjoined with a single instant of mind they perfectly know the three times without remainder, the expanse of all phenomena, and all the conduct of the minds of all sentient beings. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornment of the mind of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, release inexpressible billions upon billions of rays of light, weaving the countless rays one into another in a net of radiance that illumines every world without remainder throughout the boundless ten directions, dispelling the darkness in all world-realms. From the gateway of a smiling countenance there issue rays of light in many and varied colors — hundreds, thousands, tens of millions, billions, immeasurable and innumerable — illumining and making known the sphere of sentient beings in every single world-realm without remainder throughout the boundless and innumerable world-realms of the ten directions. They accomplish the attainment of the utmost, genuine, and perfect awakening, are inseparable from the arising of buddhas, and perform the indefeasible, irreversible, inexpressible activity of a buddha. They arise from the pure body in which buddhas appear and abide,

free from any [bounded] joy. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornment of light of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, bestow prophecies in other places, and

They remove all obscurations for every being. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornment of the Teacher, in which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, smile throughout every world without any dimness of vision.

The dharmakāya of the immeasurable buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is unobscured and utterly pure. It has penetrated the limitless dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena without edge or center, unattached to all phenomena. It is unmixed with all the world. It follows the suchness of all the world, and has entered the path of words for all the world to engage in conduct that transcends the world — a path that is cut off and inexpressible. It is free from aggregates, elements, and sense bases. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed Dharma adornment of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

The light of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is immeasurable. It is a light that shines without distinction throughout all world-realms without remainder — inexpressible, and yet again inexpressible — the ornament of manifold colors, a light that cannot be seized by any condition, a light unattached to all the world, a light immeasurable and unobscured. All the treasury-chambers of the maṇḍala of this light are like open halls. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornment of light of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

The color of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is boundless, radiant, radiant by its own nature, and immeasurable. It manifests clearly in accordance with the aspiration and faith of every single sentient being without exception. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possess an irreversible color, the supreme of all colors — it surpasses every other color and pervades and overwhelms all the colors of the three realms. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornment of color of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

Through the utterly pure virtue of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — virtue from which arises the lineage of buddhas of the past, future, and present, the precious source of virtue throughout all worlds, which no world reproaches, which is without fault — they act in a pure adornment that holds to the equality and non-equality of all phenomena in their suchness. From this arises and gathers the unblemished, utterly pure lineage of the Tathāgatas, arising from and assembled within the gnosis of omniscience. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed adornment of lineage and purity of clan of the

buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

The body of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is adorned with the power of great loving-kindness. It is supremely clear and utterly free of turbidity. The conditioning formations of the conceptual body have subsided. It is so finely revealed that one never tires of beholding it. The intention of great compassion looks with care and with wish to benefit those who hold — without refuge, as the supreme of those without shelter — the field of the gift, the field of taking refuge for all beings. It bestows the blessing of great gnosis upon all sentient beings, is elevated by its great merit, is the field of boundless merit for all beings, and causes all the aggregates of qualities and gnosis to flourish in all sentient beings. This is the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed tenth adornment of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — the adornment of great loving-kindness, great compassion, and the fullness of merit.

O children of the Victor, these then are the supreme, excellent, unsurpassed buddha adornments of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

The Noble Teaching on the Inconceivable Qualities of the Buddha, the Second Fascicle.

O children of the Victor, there are ten qualities of sovereignty and lordship of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. What are these ten? The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, by sovereign lordship over all phenomena, cause all phenomena to be illuminated. They possess boundless confidence and freedom from attachment with respect to words and letters without limit. They expound all phenomena without exception.

This is the first quality of sovereignty and lordship of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

By sovereign lordship, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, form aspirations and teach the Dharma in accordance with how sentient beings dwell and according to how they are to be tamed and fully ripened. This is the second quality of sovereign lordship of the buddhas.

By sovereign lordship, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, can shake all world-systems without remainder in six ways, yet without causing harm to even a single sentient being — adorned with immeasurable and incalculable adornments, reaching to the limits of the expanse of space, lifting all world-systems without remainder one from another, setting them down, awakening them, and hurling them, placing world-systems from one to

another and from one direction to another — and yet throughout the entire realm of sentient beings there is no delusion and no doubt. This is the third quality of sovereign lordship of the buddhas.

In a single moment of the sovereign mind of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, all world-systems without remainder are blessed with the blessing of wisdom. They bless world-systems one from another with varied adornments, display in all world-systems magnificent splendor and ornaments, and throughout innumerable eons, in all world-systems without remainder, display and manifest an unafflicted body in magnificent splendor, showing the colors of all adornments inexhaustibly, and bless all the pure buddha-fields so that they flow together into a single buddha-field. This is the fourth quality of sovereign lordship of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

By sovereign lordship, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, behold the sentient beings to be tamed by a buddha, and for the sake of a single sentient being sit in cross-legged posture for inexpressible and again inexpressible eons without stirring, attending to that individual with care, yet the body and mind of the Tathāgata know no weariness, and at the time of taming they do not pass beyond that being. Just as they do so for each and every individual, so likewise, proceeding gradually, they abide having blessed all world-systems without remainder, to the end of time, sovereign over life — yet the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, know no fatigue anywhere and no weariness. In just this way, for the sake of each individual among all sentient beings without remainder who is to be tamed by a buddha, they guide them gradually. This is the fifth quality of sovereign lordship of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

By sovereign lordship, in a single moment of mind the Tathāgata courses and goes throughout all world-systems without remainder. Traversing without measure the network of lineages of all world-systems in every direction, the ocean of transformations of the world-systems of the ten directions — every last particle of them — blessing all of them from one dharmadhātu to another, they display the dharmadhātu, turn the wheel of Dharma that cannot be seized away. This is the sixth quality of sovereign lordship of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

By sovereign lordship, in a single moment of mind, for the sake of taming the realm of sentient beings, there is no one in that single moment of mind who has become a fully and perfectly awakened buddha with unsurpassed, genuinely complete awakening in just this way, nor has there been any such

fully and perfectly awakened one, nor is there anyone who will become fully and perfectly awakened, nor any who abides on the ground of learners, nor any who has been opened to fully perfect awakening, nor any who comprehends and knows all the qualities of a buddha without obscuration.

For the sake of taming sentient beings, the unbroken stream of the domain of the great buddha-emanations never ceases, and immeasurable primordial wisdom is attained. This is the seventh quality belonging to the sovereignty of buddhahood of the blessed buddha Bhagavāns.

Through its sovereignty, whatever activity of a buddha the master of the blessed Bhagavān performs by means of the sense base of the eye, that same activity is fully accomplished through the sense base of the ear. Whatever activity of a buddha is performed by means of the sense base of the ear, that same activity is fully accomplished through the sense base of the nose. Whatever activity of a buddha is performed by means of the sense base of the nose, that same activity is fully accomplished through the sense base of the tongue. Whatever activity of a buddha is performed by means of the sense base of the tongue, that same activity is fully accomplished through the sense base of the body. Whatever activity of a buddha is performed by means of the sense base of the body, that same activity is fully accomplished through the sense base of the mind. And whatever activity of a buddha is performed by means of the sense base of the mind — through that, in all world-realms without exception, that activity is undertaken in manifold ways, and a discernment that is both worldly and transcendent is attained. In that same way, each and every undertaking is accomplished and, through emanation, however one single performance of a buddha-activity is undertaken, so too are all performances without exception. This is the eighth quality belonging to the sovereignty of buddhahood of the blessed buddha Bhagavāns.

Through its sovereign faculties, the blessed buddha Bhagavān gathers into the pore of a single hair of his body the entire realm of sentient beings — each individual sentient being, a realm of sentient beings as vast as the buddhas who are inexpressible and inexpressibly inexpressible in their greatness — drawing them all inside without remainder. And yet each individual sentient being may dwell there for countless aeons without any harm coming to them whatsoever; there is no harm of any kind.

Proceeding from one world-realm to another, realm after realm, step by step, through worlds inexpressible in number, it is known that in each of those

world-realms buddhas have arisen and are arising, that having passed through those inexpressible world-realms, the essence of sentient beings there has caused inexpressible and inexpressibly inexpressible wheels of Dharma to be turned. And within the pores of those hairs, inexpressible numbers of sentient beings, one after another, become buddhas; one after another, they turn inexpressible wheels of Dharma; one after another, they display the inexpressible dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena; one after another, they make manifest inexpressible numbers of the past, inexpressible numbers of the future, and inexpressible numbers of the present. They display the opening of the expanse of space that has no border and no center. They fully know the coming and going of all sentient beings, the sense base of their birth, the absence of obscuration, and their entry into engagement with attachment. This is the ninth quality belonging to the sovereignty of buddhahood of the blessed buddha Bhagavāns.

Through its sovereignty, the entire dharmadhātu without remainder is adorned with great lotus ornaments, and upon lotus-essence lion thrones each Tathāgata is seated. The basic space of all phenomena, the immeasurable body, the manifest and perfectly complete awakening, and the display of all buddhas in their full splendor are all shown. Just as it is with one Tathāgata, so in every world-realm, equal in number to the subtlest dust-particles, each and every essence of sentient beings is blessed in every single moment of mind. As it is with one moment of mind, so it is with every moment of mind without exception.

Just as it is with the Lotus Chapter and with the pure and perfectly manifest awakening, so it is with all the dharmadhātu without remainder, with buddha pure lands beyond number, beyond telling, and beyond all further telling, with inconceivable and varied ornaments, with the various successive arrangements that arise within world-systems, with pure lands of varied characteristics, with varied and no-varied characteristics, with immeasurable families beyond number and reckoning, with the transformation of time across innumerable ages, with the display of non-attachment, with the growth of faith in unbounded understanding, with the varied moments of mind, with the absence of any fixed abode, with inconceivable moments of mind, with going forth without limit, and with the moments of mind — and in every single moment of mind all is shown. There is none among the Blessed Buddhas who is not an object of offering. These are the ten qualities belonging to the sovereignty of buddhahood of the Blessed Buddhas.

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten qualities belonging to the sovereignty of the Blessed Buddhas. O sons of the Victor, the ten immeasurable and inconceivable qualities of the Dharma of the Blessed Buddhas that are fully perfected: what are the ten? That by which each of the marks of the hundredfold merit is completely purified, one by one, and the Blessed Buddha thereby fully and perfectly awakens to awakening — this is the first full perfection. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected all qualities of buddhahood. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected all roots of virtue. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected the source of all good qualities and accomplished pure conduct in all its fullness. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected the taming and complete maturation of sentient beings. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected the sovereign mastery of buddhahood that is not overshadowed by any being whatsoever. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected the complete purification of the pure land. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected the primordial wisdom of omniscience. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected the display, free from delusion, of the major marks and minor features of the form body. That the Blessed Buddha fully and perfectly awakens to awakening having fully perfected equality with all Tathāgatas, and passes completely into nirvāṇa having fully perfected all buddha deeds. O sons of the Victor, these are the ten fully perfected qualities of the inconceivable skillful means of the Dharma of the Blessed Buddhas.

O sons of the Victor, the ten masteries of skillful means of the Blessed Buddhas: what are the ten? Knowing all phenomena that are not blessed by the Blessed Buddha to be free from conceptual elaboration and wholesome, and then displaying and illuminating the blessing of the Blessed Buddha — this is the first mastery of skillful means of the Blessed Buddhas. The Blessed Buddhas, knowing all phenomena to be without appearance, not cognizable in relation to one another, not bound, not liberated —

having no multiplicity, being beyond contact, and having attained the supreme perfection of sovereignty over all phenomena that have not arisen — the Blessed Buddhas train with great mastery in that state of non-attachment to the ultimate limit of suchness of all things: that is, all phenomena being truly

such, being the real, being unerring suchness, being in no way other, being without self, and being phenomena with nothing to apprehend. Following that training and beholding all phenomena — this is the second mastery of skillful means of the Blessed Buddhas.

The Blessed Buddhas, free from the extreme of all characteristics and not abiding in any characteristic, not attached by virtue of their direct knowledge of characteristics — following the path of how those who speak of essential nature speak of essential nature and of the absence of essential nature — display, in a form body perfectly pure and consisting of an inconceivable assembly of form-characteristics, the exhaustion of the characteristics and behavioral characteristics of all the various realms. They perfectly hold the mass of perceptions of darkness, and display a great lamp illuminating all beings who wander in darkness. This is the third mastery of skillful means of the Blessed Buddhas.

Not attached to the beginning limit, the end limit, or what presently arises; not abiding in the past, the future, the present, or the dharmadhātu; causing the arising of buddhas of the past, the future, and the present — whose defining mark of suchness has not arisen — to appear, and teaching it as inexpressible; and thus, on account of lineages beyond measure, beholding for the sake of the buddhas, and surveying the entire domain of the buddhas — this is the fourth mastery of skillful means of the Blessed Buddhas.

The Blessed Buddhas do not accumulate actions of body, speech, or mind; they abide at the limit of what is without appropriation and without boundary; they have gone to the far shore of the abode of phenomena where nothing is cast aside. From the treasury of undetermined aspects, and through activity belonging to enumeration, they accomplish boundless accumulation; following the various worldly and supramundane gradations that belong to enumeration; manifesting diverse magical powers, limitless and boundless, through the vision of unobscured wisdom; and taming and making aware all sentient beings throughout the entirety of the dharmadhātu — this is the fifth mastery of skillful means of the Blessed Buddhas.

All phenomena proceeding as having no appearance and no variety — proceeding as having no non-existence, proceeding as not having arisen, proceeding as without defining mark, proceeding as without variety, proceeding as without adornment, proceeding as without appropriation, proceeding as without essential nature — and yet fully knowing all

phenomena, and supremely knowing how to draw them forth in sequence from the expanse of phenomena; making them non-contradictory with worldly phenomena; beholding without truly existent essential nature; knowing all things and seeing all things; seeing all things without remainder through wisdom; causing all phenomena to appear through mastery, and not shifting from the essential nature of suchness — this is the sixth mastery of skillful means of the Blessed Buddhas.

That which, at one and the same time, understands and knows a single characteristic in relation to all others — entering into pure phenomena in their raw immediacy, possessing wholesome roots that are equal and perfectly pure, not remaining in anything fixed — neither entering in accordance with a single day, a half-month, a year, a hundred years, or the contraction and change of a kalpa, nor turning back — in relation to that which is the very rawness of phenomena and which does not abide at any time — time beyond measure, a single day, a brief moment, and

the morning, midday, the afternoon, the evening, midnight, the hours before dawn, the day, periods that can be counted, seven days, a fortnight, a month, a year, a hundred years, a single kalpa, immeasurable time, countless time, inconceivable time, inexpressible time — teaching the Dharma at all times up to the very end of the future age. In the wheel of Dharma there is neither abiding nor turning back; the stream is never cut; there is no conjunction; there is no interruption; nothing is cast aside; nothing shifts; nothing wavers; it is not prolonged; nor does it abide at any extreme. This is the seventh of the skillful means in buddhahood of the blessed buddhas.

The blessed buddhas have obtained the entirety of the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, without remainder; fearlessness (*vaiśāradya*) beyond measure; analytical wisdom (*pratisaṃvid*) beyond counting; analytical wisdom beyond measure; analytical wisdom that is inexhaustible; analytical wisdom without fixed abode; analytical wisdom without limit; analytical wisdom; analytical wisdom that is nowhere to be grasped; analytical wisdom of suchness; analytical wisdom pertaining to words, modes, and individual conceptual categories; analytical wisdom that encompasses all phenomena; and in accordance with intention, faith, and faculty — showing the boundaries of the textual tradition of the Dharma together with those phenomena designated in their various ways — perfectly revealing the beginning, middle, and end of sūtras beyond expression, innumerable and inexpressible, a hundred thousand billions upon billions. This is the eighth of the skillful means

in buddhahood of the blessed buddhas.

The absence of name, yet name; lineage; arising; the name of all phenomena; differentiation; the blazing of elements; the manifestation of complete and perfect awakening; the name of what is without past; the name of what is without future; the name of what is without present occurrence; the name of what is without sentient beings; the name of what is without a buddha-field; the name of what is without phenomena; the name of what is without qualities; the name of what is without bodhisattvas; the name of what is without buddhas; the name of what is innumerable; the name of what is not innumerable; the name of what has not arisen; the name of what is non-cessation; the name of what does not exist; the name of what is not non-existent; the name of what is not one; the name of what is not any aspect whatsoever — all these are inexpressible by intrinsic nature.

All phenomena are not a direction, not a convention, stripped of the sounds of verbal expression, not established and not produced by any sound that has arisen — neither produced as a single appearance nor as many appearances — having obtained the supreme perfection (*pāramitā*) beyond expression, wherein all speech is inexpressible; endowed with non-engagement in the domain of complete non-conceptuality; with all thought (*vitarka*), deliberation (*vikalpa*), and thorough investigation ceased; abiding in non-abiding with regard to all speech. This is the ninth of the skillful means in buddhahood of the blessed buddhas.

Knowing that all phenomena of form are unborn — not feeling, not conceptual elaboration, not enumerable, not the activity of perception, not formations, not grasping, not consciousness — perfectly knowing them to be at peace by intrinsic nature; engaging without sense bases; non-perception of the *dharmadhātu*, the basic space of all phenomena; fearlessness with respect to all phenomena; no arising of all phenomena — equal by intrinsic nature to space; all phenomena being solitary; arising from that which is not karma, is without activity, is unborn —

not yet arisen; understood as manifold in enumeration; neither existent nor non-existent; unborn; unceased; neither defiled nor purified; without name; not raw or unrefined; neither abiding nor thoroughly abiding; not thoroughly ripened; not tamed; without sentient beings, yet not without sentient beings; without a life-force, yet not without a life-force; without conditions, yet not without conditions; not without the gathering of conditions — knowing all

phenomena thus omnisciently; having attained the supreme perfection that reveals the dharmadhātu, the basic space of all phenomena.

Through the determined abiding of the three assemblies — the definite, the indefinite, the wrongly determined, and the undetermined — together with the ten powers of the Tathāgata, the gnosis of omniscience, and the purification of the four fearlessnesses: this is the great domain of buddhahood. These, then, are the ten kinds of mastery in the means of buddhahood of the blessed buddhas.

O sons of the Victors, these are the ten kinds of mastery in the means of buddhahood of the blessed buddhas. O sons of the Victors, the deeds of the blessed buddhas and the blessings of the buddhas are vast, measureless, inconceivable — incapable of being gauged by gods or the world, incapable of being entered into by all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas of the past, the future, and the present. There are ten such things. What are these ten?

The extent of the expanse of space that encompasses all world-systems in the ten directions without remainder; the basic space of all phenomena; demonstrating birth in Tuṣita heaven in all world-systems; the conduct of bodhisattvas; the boundless deeds of buddhas; colors beyond measure; splendor beyond measure; light beyond measure; basic space beyond measure; pure vocal qualities beyond measure; the limitless recognition of proclaimed sounds; abiding in measureless meditative absorptions; the domain of wisdom and gnosis beyond measure; the care for extremes and the world; the care for the world of māras, Brahmā, ascetics (śramaṇas), brahmins, beings, gods, humans, and the world of asuras; the domain of great loving-kindness that cannot be stolen away; care for sentient beings directed toward the edge of great compassion; care for sentient beings destined to be born in the higher realms; the perfection of the power of merit and its faculties; the care for sentient beings whose faculties are purified and whose minds are entirely clear; the care for sentient beings purified in the various vehicles; the care for sentient beings who have fully completed the Great Vehicle; and the care for sentient beings who emerge from all destinies. This is the complete and perfect purity of the deeds and conduct of the blessed buddhas.

Descending from Tuṣita, entering into the womb of his mother; the life as a bodhisattva; birth into one's own body; conduct like an illusion; touching upon meditative absorption like an emanation; cognition like a flickering optical

illusion; a domain extended as boundlessly as space; unattached, as if by wish, to birth; like a mirage; like uniform appearance; following phenomena free from affliction; entering into gnosis that has no fixed abode; by intrinsic nature free from attachment and utterly pure — even the limit of birth into one's own body, that great treasury of finest garments and great ornaments, performs the deeds of a buddha. Dwelling in a great sacred place, a towered mansion adorned with great jewels and worshipped with precious things, one performs the deeds of a buddha.

By miraculous powers one performs the deeds of a buddha; by the blessing of great mental engagement one performs the deeds of a buddha; by revealing the treasury of great emanation one performs the deeds of a buddha; by the solar disc of great primordial wisdom one performs the deeds of a buddha; by abiding in that which is unborn from a mother one performs the deeds of a buddha; by fully attaining the great domain, the domain of a buddha, one performs the deeds of a buddha; by the boundless blessing of a buddha in the world one performs the deeds of a buddha; by moving through and resting in meditative equipoise within countless great meditative absorptions one performs the deeds of a buddha; by arising from each of those meditative absorptions one performs the deeds of a buddha; and through the beginning, the middle, and the end — from the very first conduct all the way to the far shore of great and complete nirvāṇa — one performs the deeds of a buddha. Having blessed everything from this ground to the second, one then demonstrates knowledge of the measure of worlds; and through various kinds of splendor one performs the deeds of a buddha throughout every world. As one who has become youthful one performs the deeds of a buddha throughout every world. As one who has become a bodhisattva one performs the deeds of a buddha throughout every world. Through coming forth, fully awakening, and turning the wheel of Dharma one performs the deeds of a buddha throughout every world without exception. Through skillful means of many kinds one performs the deeds of a buddha throughout every world without exception. Through their diversity one performs the deeds of a buddha in the world. Through an ocean-like stream extending across immeasurable worlds, all worlds, and every direction, and through one's lineage, one performs the deeds of a buddha throughout every world. Through every realm and every time one performs the deeds of a buddha in the world. Through every karmic maturation without exception one performs the deeds of a buddha in the world. Through every lineage of sentient beings without exception one

performs the deeds of a buddha in the world. Through dying and being reborn, and through every lineage without exception, one performs the deeds of a buddha in the world. Through great emanation, through lineage, through the lineage of buddhas, and through the wheel of the gateway of mindfulness of the Dharma one performs the deeds of a buddha. This is the second of the buddha deeds of the blessed buddhas.

Through purification arising from virtuous conduct, and through all births; through wisdom and pure conduct; through following the demonstration of birth; through taming sentient beings and bringing them to full maturity; through bringing all roots of virtue to complete fulfillment; through following the guidance that shows sentient beings what they need — while all buddhas, free from attachment, dwell in dwelling and in non-dwelling; through individually discerning, free from every sound and voice; through discerning all existence, and what arises in existence among human beings; through letting all things enter into primordial wisdom; through completely fulfilling all ethical discipline to the culmination of omniscience; through surveying beings with the eye of great compassion, as if with a hook; through individually discerning the objects of mind with great loving-kindness; through making the joy of the world known by means of great joy; through ruling and engaging the mind with great equanimity;

through completely perfecting within oneself the qualities of omniscience; through manifesting the body in every part of the dharmadhātu without remainder; through completely perfecting the body that abides nowhere and in no way; through earnestly purifying the entire retinue and assembly; through teaching, speaking, and proclaiming the Dharma; through reproaching the lords of the world; through showing the karmic maturation of the roots of virtue in accordance with how beings of all classes act, perceiving their faults; through taming sentient beings in accordance with their situation; through ripening sentient beings who are not yet ripe; through taming those who are already ripe; through manifesting immeasurable skillful means; through showing without turning back from the buddha's deeds; through illuminating the Dharma through the many doors of conduct; through purifying the minds of sentient beings of every kind who dwell in no fixed abode; through sending down a cloud of Dharma born of great compassion; through entering into loving-kindness as a bee goes to flowers, and sending down the three miraculous transformations; through discerning and perceiving clearly the view toward all buddhas, and showing that one abides in the midst of

immeasurable rays of light; through showing the buddha's deeds in the world at the furthest edge and center, and in worlds without a lord; through abiding in great primordial wisdom and manifesting the superknowledge (abhijñā) of the buddhas that is unhindered and unobscured; and through being skilled in means with respect to the three dharmas at the culmination of action — that is, through being completely pure in bodily action, through being completely pure in the primordial wisdom of speech that wastes nothing, and through being skilled in means brought to their culmination in the profound and unattached action of mind — working for the benefit of sentient beings. This is the third deed of the buddha among the Blessed One buddhas.

With the great and magnificent victory of one who has fully gone forth, adorned with ornaments of immeasurable rays of light, abandoning all that is pleasing, showing the conduct of renunciation, drawing in sentient beings who dwell in the world; making the world become deeply attached; making the world understand that the number of worlds is incalculable; turning back attachment to the many kinds of worlds; cutting off craving for the world's pleasures; leading the world, with afflictions relinquished, into purification; making all aims and purposes be kept in mind; guiding beings for the sake of going forth; showing the relinquishment of all the marks of the householder; applying and establishing beings in the affliction-free Dharma; completely fulfilling all former aspirational prayers; illuminating the maṇḍala of immeasurable qualities; individually finding the maṇḍala of great primordial wisdom, while beholding the cataract of ignorance among sentient beings; and, having oneself become the supreme unsurpassable field of merit, drawing all beings near; gathering all roots of virtue and praising before all living beings every root of virtue born from the buddhas; being a Teacher who sees the aim of primordial wisdom; proclaiming to sentient beings the gateway of complete purity; introducing sentient beings to the gateway of blamelessness; fully showing to all the world the gateway of renunciation; going forth and raising aloft the victory banner of omniscience. This is the fourth deed of the buddha among the Blessed One buddhas.

Proceeding to the foot of the tree of awakening, endowed with manifold deeds and primordial wisdoms, and reaching the culmination of the primordial wisdom of omniscience, becoming fully and manifestly awakened under awakening, and thus comprehending all phenomena at heart —

— utterly vanquishing the power of māra, and being the treasury of bodily blessing that nothing can overshadow; pervading the entire dharmadhātu

without remainder; abandoning the furthest extreme of inexhaustible blessing; having fully attained conduct of measureless scope, moving in pursuit of the aim of wisdom that ranges freely across the domain of omniscience; perfecting and fully completing the qualities of omniscience; causing the adorned thrones to shine forth in every world-realm without exception; causing bodhisattvas to become fully aware in all buddha-fields without exception; having fully attained the supreme conduct of bodhisattvas; beholding all the maṇḍalas of the assemblies of bodhisattvas in their aspects, and beholding with perfect discernment the aspirational prayers; attending to all bodhisattvas; turning the wheel of profound Dharma for bodhisattvas of the profound; embarking upon the realm of measureless buddhas; following in the wake of the source of innumerable bodhisattvas and engaging in manifold conduct; purifying the maṇḍala of the bodhisattva assembly; making all the world into the domain of the blessing of the buddhas; causing sentient beings to become fully aware of their roots of virtue; abiding in the power of limitless bodhisattva conduct that arises from all roots of virtue being inseparable, and fully attaining the furthest limit without remainder of the distinction of all qualities, and dwelling thus; going throughout all worlds; going to the furthest limit of all sentient beings without remainder; going throughout all fields; going throughout all phenomena; going throughout all bodhisattvas; going throughout all that is to be ripened; going throughout all times; going throughout all that is to be trained; going throughout the sport and display of all buddhas; and fully and fittingly ascertaining the faith of all beings without remainder — performing the deeds of a buddha. This is the fifth deed of the buddha among the Blessed One buddhas.

The Blessed One buddhas turn the wheel of Dharma in the mode of irreversibility, an irreversible wheel; the wheel turned in the mode of causing all the world to know directly; the wheel turned in the mode of becoming fully and manifestly awakened in all without exception and without remainder, and of the great fearless lion's roar; the wheel that is the treasury of wisdom of all phenomena and the illumination of the gateway to the treasury of Dharma free from darkness; the wheel turned in the mode of wisdom measureless and unattached, like the face of open space; the wheel turned in the mode of discerning distinctly all phenomena, whose essential nature is without inherent existence, unobscured; the wheel turned in the mode of fully purifying the eye of Dharma of all sentient beings and being the lamp of all the world; the wheel that illuminates the Dharma of omniscience, turned in the mode of pervading

all the world in the three times; the wheel turned in the mode of the oneness of all buddhas, concordant with the Dharma of all buddhas without contradiction — these and countless others like them: wheels of Dharma in the hundreds of thousands of koṭis beyond reckoning, wheels of Dharma turned that proceed in accordance with the conduct of the minds of all sentient beings. By thus turning the wheel of Dharma, the Blessed One buddhas perform inconceivable deeds of a buddha.

This is the sixth deed of a buddha performed by the Blessed One buddhas.

Furthermore, by entering into villages, towns, districts, and royal palaces, the Blessed One buddhas also perform deeds of a buddha for sentient beings. Upon entering through the gates of a city, the earth trembles and a radiance of light rays floods forth: the blind each receive their sight; the deaf each hear sounds; the mad each recover their minds; the naked each find clothing; those in suffering each attain ease; musical instruments and drums that have not been struck give forth pleasing tones, and drums unstruck sound, and hanging ornaments sway and ring, and the sounds of manifold and varied brahmin voices become pleasing. By displaying a form-body that one can never tire of beholding and that has nothing discordant in it, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha for sentient beings. By displaying the major marks and minor features, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha. By gazing in every direction, by looking about with wide eyes, by extending and drawing in the limbs, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha for sentient beings. By their supernatural knowledge, by going and rising, by walking and standing and lying down, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha for sentient beings. By teaching the Dharma and by remaining utterly silent, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha for sentient beings. By the miraculous display of supernormal powers, by the miraculous display of teaching, and by the miraculous display of further instruction, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha for sentient beings.

Moreover, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha for all sentient beings in the world through the following: the entire ocean of the intentions of sentient beings in all their variety; the countless modes of conduct in the world; the domains of world-systems; abiding in the great roots of virtue; recollecting the former abodes of buddhas; following after bodhisattvas and the perfectly awakened buddhas with inexhaustible delight in beholding their form-bodies; the arising and birth of buddhas, the speaking of their words, the

seeing of Tathāgatas, the extreme rarity of their speech; all white dharmas (Skt. śukladharma — pure and wholesome qualities); sources of merit; pleasing the buddhas; entering into the Tathāgatas who are of boundless and infinite color; all sentient beings directly realizing the Tathāgata; comprehending the Tathāgata's perception of the inconceivably vast multitudes of sentient beings; and the Tathāgata looking upon and entering into all buddha-fields. By thus engaging with all roots of virtue, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha for all sentient beings in the world.

And further, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha even for those sentient beings who, with purified and devoted hearts, prostrate and join their palms, who follow after buddhas, who sing praises and recite their names, who again and again call them to mind, who look upon them with admiration, who keep them vividly in memory, and who hold the buddhas dear with hearts of genuine affection.

And further, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha for those sentient beings who keep the buddhas in mind with recollection. For those sentient beings who wish to behold the buddhas, the Blessed One buddhas give them the taste of the way of life of a buddha, lead the entire world into purification through the arising of a buddha, show them the qualities of a buddha and their boundless hues of light, and through the lineage-holders of Tathāgatas of buddhas yet to come, there are roots of virtue, manifold forms of faith, and the performance of the deeds of the Blessed One buddhas. And further, for those sentient beings who behold the form of a Tathāgata in its countless hues and shapes of immeasurable variety, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha. And for those sentient beings who hear the voice of a Tathāgata, the Blessed One buddhas perform deeds of a buddha.

In these and in boundless, inconceivable, inexpressible ways — in hundreds of thousands of millions of forms — the Blessed One buddhas engage in the deeds of a buddha and, throughout every single world-realm, guide all sentient beings precisely in accordance with the power of their aspirations, never transgressing what is fitting to tame each one. Thus they lead the entire world to engage in all the deeds of a buddha, never turning back from their domain, sending forth great compassion, never growing weary of their former aspirations, and by the power of the gnosis of the deeds of a buddha, attending with discernment to all beings, abiding in the conduct of the minds of all sentient beings, and having obtained measureless, boundless virtue in abundance. This is the seventh deed of a buddha performed by the Blessed

One buddhas.

Moreover, while dwelling in forest hermitages, while the Blessed One buddhas abide in peace, while dwelling in solitude, while the Blessed One buddhas abide in peace and dwell in solitude within the domain of a buddha's practice, while abiding and dwelling in great meditative absorption rejoicing in aloneness, while dwelling with the body invisible to ordinary sight, while abiding and dwelling in profound gnosis, while dwelling in the power of the domain of measureless buddhas, while dwelling uninterruptedly in a manner of bodily conduct that is beyond ordinary perception — even so, the Blessed One buddhas engage in the deeds of all buddhas. They tame sentient beings precisely in accordance with their aspirations and devotion, through gnosis that no other can match, and through the manner of their aspirational prayers they engage in the deeds of a buddha.

They engage in the deeds of a buddha by seeking out buddhas among the gods, by seeking out buddhas among the nāgas, by seeking out buddhas among the garuḍas, by seeking out buddhas among the kiṃnaras, by seeking out buddhas among the great serpents, by seeking out buddhas among those who blaze with fire, by seeking out buddhas among humans and non-humans, by seeking out buddhas among those of the śrāvaka vehicle, the pratyekabuddha vehicle, the bodhisattvas, and among buddhas themselves. They engage in the deeds of a buddha by teaching the Dharma. They engage in the deeds of a buddha through the power of a single buddha. They engage in the deeds of a buddha through the power of all buddhas. Through the distinction of the conduct of all bodhisattvas, through the gathering together of aspiration into one, through the unfolding of the conduct of a single bodhisattva, through the power of the progression of conduct, through the domain of the world and the power of the domain of buddhas, through the domain of buddhas and the power of the domain of the world, through what is not a domain and through the power of the domain of buddhas — by all of these they perform the deeds of a buddha. Through the night and through the day, through the half-month, through a single year —

whether abiding for a countable duration or abiding for an inexpressible number of yet further inexpressible aeons — by all of these the blessed buddhas perform the deeds of a buddha for sentient beings. This is the eighth deed of a buddha of the blessed buddhas.

Becoming like a dwelling place; the purification of roots of virtue; the buddhas causing the intentions of all sentient beings to become faith; entering into mind and engaging in accomplishment for those who have become devoted; the taming of the faculties; the arising of faith in all sentient beings and all creatures; the arising of all destinies; the inspiring of all bodhisattvas; resting in conceptual thought while causing the light of gnosis to appear; the passing into nirvāṇa that does not rely upon another's guidance; the blessed buddhas displaying nirvāṇa while not interrupting the stream of buddha deeds; displaying the impermanence of the world; not interrupting the stream of the display of the buddhas' radiance; gathering together the ultimate purpose of all that has been accomplished; making the entry into Dharma appear through the completeness of every essential nature; causing the eye of existence to appear for those whose root has been cut; displaying weariness to sentient beings; harmonizing with the minds of those who have followed after the buddhas; displaying to sentient beings the limit of life; closely showing all sentient beings the lack of delight in the world; gladdening sentient beings with regard to the arising of buddhas yet to come; the blessed buddhas turning the wheel of Dharma that is beyond reproach and causing it to be thoroughly understood; causing the joy of the world to appear; the buddhas possessing and establishing minds of composure; rousing those sentient beings who recollect the Tathāgata and engage in thorough reflection with pure view; turning back the weariness of the faculties and thoroughly purifying them; accomplishing all joyful devotion toward the buddhas; blessing sentient beings who have found weariness; obtaining the condition of the loving intention of the buddhas in every single world-realm without exception; grasping sentient beings with the Tathāgata's body in all cases of bodily dispersal; and placing the agitated and intoxicated sentient beings of the world into the vow. This is the ninth deed of a buddha of the blessed buddhas.

Ah, when the Tathāgatas have passed into nirvāṇa, all the sentient beings of the world will lament, weep, grieve, and shed tears, crying out: "The perfectly and completely awakened one — the one of great compassion — the great captain — the one of loving heart — the protector of gods and of the world together and of all sentient beings — the refuge — the ally — he who has gone beyond the unsurpassed field of merit — he who rejoices in the arising of the blessed buddhas" — and so lamenting and grieving, those sentient beings who recollect seeing the buddhas enter into the immeasurable deeds of a buddha. It is thus that, in those various states, after the blessed buddhas have fully

passed into nirvāṇa, in accordance with the intentions and mental engagement of sentient beings, the blessed buddhas bless the relics and the relic shrines in accordance with the faith and intention of sentient beings — for gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and great serpents,

and for humans in every land — blessing the relics and the relic shrines in accordance with how each is to be trained and in accordance with the faith of each. Having relinquished their own bodies, the blessed buddhas bless relics and relic shrines in a measure that is immeasurable, innumerable, inconceivable, and inexpressible beyond the inexpressible — by the power of the minds that are devoted to the sentient beings of this world, by the power of the veneration offered through the faith of sentient beings, by the power of the supremely purified superior intentions of sentient beings, by the power of the full ripening of sentient beings, by the power of the full purification of sentient beings, by the power of the training of sentient beings, by the power of the complete fulfillment of the accumulation of merit of sentient beings, by the power of sentient beings engaging in the worship of the Tathāgatas, by the power of the growth of the roots of virtue of sentient beings in many and various lands who adorn the relic shrines of the Tathāgatas, and by the power of the buddhas' relics being distributed and made into relic shrines by all the world. In those various lands and regions, the relics and relic shrines shall be venerated in the abodes of gods, in the abodes of nāgas, in the abodes of yakṣas, of gandharvas, of asuras, of garuḍas, of kinnaras, of great serpents, in the abodes of humans, and in the realms of fire. Relic shrines of bodily relics, of bone relics, of hair, and of nail clippings, and relic shrines erected at the places where the buddhas resided — all beings without exception will come to recollect the buddhas, will come to follow the Dharma, and will each individually come to find faith in the Saṅgha. Dwelling in those various lands and regions with the constant intention of offering without interruption, they will give gifts and accumulate merit, and they will each individually attain the pure higher rebirths. They will each individually attain to great lineages. They will each individually attain great wealth and a retinue of pure attendants. They will each experience the excellence of gods and humans. They will perfectly fulfill the diligence of non-falling into lower states. When buddhas arise, they will practice free from delusion. They will each individually fulfill their establishment in the white dharmas (wholesome qualities). They will perfectly fulfill the qualities that arise from the three realms. In accordance

with their faith in the vehicle and their aspirational prayers, they will take birth. Each of those beings will come to know what has been done for the Tathāgatas and will each individually attain the requital of those deeds — following, dwelling with, protected by, taking refuge in, and befriended by the blessed buddhas who are Victors. Thus, even through the complete nirvāṇa of the blessed buddhas, the inconceivable field of giving is purified — the field of giving in which merit does not abide — and the blessed buddhas arise in the world in this manner in many different aspects, so that the roots of virtue of sentient beings grow and the accumulation of merit is fully completed. This is the tenth buddha-deed of the blessed buddhas.

O sons of the Victor, this is the vast, immeasurable, and inconceivable scope of the buddha-deeds of the blessed buddhas. Apart from the blessing of the buddhas, no god together with all the worlds of every realm could measure it, and even the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas of the past, the future, and the present are not capable of penetrating it.

The noble text setting forth the inconceivable qualities of the buddhas — the third section.

O sons of the Victor, the blessed buddhas proceed in ten non-dual ways through the Dharma of the non-dual essential nature of the chief among dharmas. What are the ten? This is the first: all the blessed buddhas prophecy and proceed in non-duality —

The blessed buddhas proceed in non-duality through the minds and intentions of the countless, innumerable, and inexpressible varieties of sentient beings who recollect the buddhas. Non-dual is the body of the perfectly awakened one who has awakened to the exhaustive totality of the meaning of the Dharma. Non-dual is the wisdom of the Tathāgata with regard to past, future, and present as they arise in their essential nature. Non-dual is the wisdom of the very last moment of arising, and non-dual are the first and final extremes and the present moment. Non-dual is the wisdom that reveals the following of all the buddha-fields of the buddhas of the three times and the following of the field of a single buddha. Non-dual is the speech of a single buddha and the speech of all the buddhas. Non-dual are the discipline, the reproach, and the discernment of all the Tathāgatas. Non-dual are the nature of reality of all worlds and the nature of reality of the buddhas. Non-dual are all the roots of virtue of all the buddhas of the past, the future, and the present, and the roots of virtue of any single one among them. O sons of the Victor, this is how the

blessed buddhas proceed in non-duality through the Dharma of the chief among dharmas, which is the non-dual Dharma.

O sons of the Victor, the blessed buddhas, the Tathāgatas, abide with diligent attention to all phenomena in ten ways. What are the ten? The blessed buddhas abide in the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, and abide in awakening following after wisdom. The blessed buddhas abide in great compassion. The blessed buddhas abide in the arising of aspirations, however they have been made. The blessed buddhas abide in disciplining sentient beings without ever abandoning them. The blessed buddhas abide in the nature of reality that is thoroughly established in having no essential nature. The blessed buddhas abide in what is not purposeless, and they abide in not regarding the Tathāgatas as beings of equal fortune. The blessed buddhas constantly abide in equanimity of mind. The blessed buddhas abide in the faculty by which all phenomena remain undiminished. The blessed buddhas abide in conduct free of attachment. The blessed buddhas enter into the equality of all phenomena and abide in the characteristic of authentic ultimate fearlessness. O sons of the Victor, these are the ten ways in which the blessed buddhas, the Tathāgatas, abide with diligent attention to all phenomena.

O sons of the Victor, the blessed buddhas have ten modes of direct, fully knowing awareness of all phenomena without exception. What are the ten? They are as follows: the direct knowing of all the enumerations of the past within the entirety of the dharmadhātu; the direct knowing of all the enumerations of the future; the direct knowing of all the enumerations of the present; the direct knowing of all the paths of all speech; the direct knowing of all the modes of engagement of all worlds; the direct knowing of all the wisdom of the essential nature of all sentient beings; the direct knowing of the defining characteristics of the small, middling, and great roots of virtue of all bodhisattvas, together with their various states, and of the wisdom at every moment of an uninterrupted boundary that perfects all the roots of virtue and the immeasurable aspirations; the direct knowing of the full comprehension of the assembly of conditions and accumulations of all phenomena; the direct knowing of seeing the wisdom that thoroughly distinguishes the lineages of all world-systems; and the direct knowing of the dharmadhātu, its distinctions laid out in full, like a master illusionist elaborating forms —

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten direct knowings through which the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, directly know, without remainder, all phenomena. O sons of the Victor, there are ten Dharma qualities abiding in the splendor of

great power and strength that belong to the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — the great power, the power, the immeasurable power, the magnificent nature of power, the power that is difficult to withstand, the power that is wholly undiminished, the essential power, the unsplittable power, the power inconceivable to all worlds, and the power that cannot be seized by any sentient being — the power of the buddhas' great might. What are the ten?

The first is this: the body of a buddha cannot be split open by any opposing adversary; the faculty of life cannot be cut short by all the world-systems together, nor is it frightened by poison; it cannot be burned by the kalpa-fire of conflagration that consumes all world-systems; it cannot be drowned by masses of water that flood and submerge all world-systems; it is unassailable by the strength of the eyes of all māras and all the hosts of māras, all gods, all nāgas, all yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, great mahoragas, humans and non-humans, flesh-eaters, all blazing spirits, and every sentient being without exception. Even a rain of vajras equal to Mount Meru were to fall, and further a rain of vajras equal to the great encircling iron mountains, and still further a rain of vajras the full measure of the great trichiliocosm — not a single body-hair of that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, would be stirred; he would feel not even a moment of discomfort; there would be no abandoning of the comportments of walking, standing, sitting, and lying down in whatever realm that Tathāgata abided; and the Tathāgata would not descend to that realm in any measure less than he wished to be present everywhere. The praises of the Buddha would not be diminished, nor would the beings blessed by the Buddha's consecration be harmed — how much less, then, could the body of the Tathāgata be disturbed. This is the first Dharma quality abiding in the splendor of the great power and strength of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

Furthermore, if the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, so wished, all world-systems without remainder — together with the supreme expanse of all phenomena, all world-systems, Mount Meru and its surrounding ranges, the great encircling iron mountains, the ocean mountains and dense forests, the various dwelling places of sentient beings, and every one of those world-systems without exception — could be gathered into a single pore of a Tathāgata's body-hair and held there for the duration of a kalpa at the outermost limit of the final end of time. Apart from the Tathāgata's own blessing, no other sentient being could know this. Those innumerable world-systems, all of them gathered into a single pore of the body-hair of the Tathāgata himself, would be held there for

kalpas reaching to the ultimate outermost limit of time; and though the Tathāgata were to rise, walk, sit, lie down, and travel through kalpas, not a single instant of suffering would arise in the Tathāgata's mind. There would be no weariness, no diminishment of power and might, and no conceptual thought concerning his comportments.

O sons of the Victor, consider this analogy: space encompasses without remainder all the dharmadhātu and all world-systems, yet it is not oppressed, not subdued, not increased, not diminished, not arisen, not born, and has no form.

In the same way, the blessed buddhas may gather within a single hair-pore all world-systems without remainder, yet on that account not a single mind-moment of painful feeling arises in them. This is a quality attained by the blessed buddhas through abiding in the splendor of the power of the great might of buddhahood.

Furthermore, in the course of a single step, a blessed buddha traverses buddha-fields equal in number to the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields. He travels through kalpas equal in number to those same infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields. He goes forth in that way, with many mind-moments arising and entering, traveling through kalpas equal in number to the subtlest dust-particles of all world-systems. He travels through kalpas corresponding to the arising of awakening mind in all world-systems without remainder, pervading all world-systems equal in number to the subtlest dust-particles of all those world-systems — limitless and measureless — and passing through buddha-fields equal in number to the subtlest dust-particles of distinct buddha-fields corresponding to the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible turnings of the great surrounding mountain ranges, all converging into a single hair-pore. Just as with that one hair-pore, so it is with every hair-pore of his body: all sentient beings, however many there are, come to rest within those hair-pores. With all those sentient beings pressing down upon him, the Tathāgata holds them at the tip of a single finger through kalpas reaching to the ultimate outermost limit of time. Just as he first holds them with one finger, so he holds them with the tips of all his fingers — yet on that account not the slightest forgetting of the Tathāgata's body arises, nor does weariness arise in his mind, nor does even the subtlest trace of a thought arise that he is experiencing the touch of suffering. In that same way, he goes and enters each and every world-system;

he goes and enters into space; he goes and enters in all the directions of the vast expanse; he goes and enters to the very ends of all the reaches of the space element; he enters to the very ends of the dharmadhātu; he enters into every element reaching to the measure of the tips of hairs; and for each hair-tip's measure, he enters into all the reaches of the space element, filling numberless space-elements equal to the measure of each hair-tip. Throughout all of this, from the first extreme to the last extreme of the Tathāgata's conduct, through kalpas reaching their exhaustion and passing, he sits in a single cross-legged posture in each and every direction, fully at ease and enjoying complete presence. This is the fourth quality of the blessed buddhas, attained through abiding in the splendor of the power of the great might of buddhahood.

Furthermore, the blessed buddha manifests bodies as numerous as the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields, and likewise countless heads. In each head arise tongues as numerous as the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields, and from those tongues pour forth notes of sound, syllables of voice, and utterances — making the entire dharmadhātu, without remainder, comprehensible to the realm of sentient beings. Each note, each syllable of voice, each utterance fully expounds holy sūtras as numerous as the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields; each sūtra is followed by the teaching of Dharma in topics as numerous as the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields; and for each teaching of Dharma there flows forth an exposition of Dharma-words and analyses as numerous as the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields.

Just as Dharma is taught for any given purpose, so all phenomena are taught. Each is taught for aeons as numerous as the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields; and when those aeons as numerous as the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields are utterly exhausted, the teaching continues again for aeons as numerous as the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields. This teaching expounds for aeons as numerous as the subtlest dust-particles of all world-systems; and even when

aeons as numerous as the subtlest dust-particles of all world-systems are exhausted, even when aeons equal to the movements of the minds of all sentient beings have passed away, the Tathāgata's emanation is not thereby diminished. All phenomena are engaged like a firebrand wheel, and all phenomena are taught through wisdom. The wheel of Dharma that communicates and cuts through all doubt turns; the wheel of Dharma that illuminates all phenomena turns; the wheel of the treasure-store that is free from attachment turns; the wheel of Dharma adorned with the training that satisfies limitless sentient beings turns; the wheel adorned with the summation of all bodhisattva conduct turns; the wheel of the continuous stream of the great maṇḍala of the sun of primordial wisdom turns; the wheel of the continuous stream of the great lamp of primordial wisdom for all beings without exception turns; and the wheel of Dharma adorned with the great fearlessness and the analytical knowledges (pratisaṃvid) turns. Indeed, even the great cloud of the turning wheel of Dharma produced by the blessing of the body of a single buddha is beyond all comparison and simile.

Thus, throughout the entirety of the dharmadhātu (basic space of phenomena), through to the farthest reaches of the expanse of space — even to the tips of a hair's breadth, in every direction, without remainder — the emanations of buddhas as numerous as the moments of mind equal to the infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields arise with each and every moment of mind; and until the final kalpa, each body of the nirmāṇakāya (emanation body) of all the Tathāgatas is multiplied to that same measure, each of those bodies becoming a head of that same number upon number, and upon each head that same number upon number of tongues, upon each tongue that same number upon number of voice-branches, speech, body, and vocal activity — making all of the dharmadhātu without remainder resound throughout the realm of sentient beings. Through each voice-branch, each sound, each utterance, that same number upon number of sūtras are fully expounded; for each sūtra that same number upon number of Dharma-teachings follow; for each Dharma-teaching that same number upon number of Dharma-words and analyses flow forth; and each Dharma-word and analysis makes all of the dharmadhātu without remainder clearly resound and causes understanding in the entire realm of sentient beings without exception. Yet the speech of the Tathāgata neither grasps, nor degrades, nor is exhausted, nor is impeded. Abiding thus until the final boundary of the

ultimate kalpa, it turns the wheel of Dharma. This is the fifth quality of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, which abides in the glory of the power of great buddha-might.

Furthermore, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are endowed with the continuous stream of the calf of the glory of their enlightened mind,

Those held in the great vajra-essence proceed to the foot of the tree of awakening, and there, before all sentient beings in their entirety, they cause the hosts of sinful māras, in their many and varied forms — repulsive and supremely terrifying — to be scattered and dispelled, transforming them into forms that inspire the arising of the awakening mind in every being in the world.

Having gone to the foot of that supreme tree of awakening, seizing the repulsive forms of māra at the sky's edge in the expanse of all phenomena, creating great terror through tremendous fright, destroying all beings, and shattering the entire world — in that very moment, the Tathāgata arrives at the foot of the tree of awakening, gazes upon all of this, and having gazed, feels no fear, no shame, not a single hair stirs. He holds no attachment to the variegated marks of varied forms; not the subtlest movement of mind is present. He abides unmoved, unstirred, unchanging, free of conceptual thought, profoundly and utterly at peace. There is not the slightest trace of trembling or hair standing on end, not the slightest trace of desire or anger. He performs the deeds of a buddha, releasing them through the power of great loving-kindness free of attachment. He conceals his faculties and abides in great compassion. With a mind whose essential quality is shamelessness inseparable from its ground, a mind that is neither broken nor overwhelmed, he subdues and utterly vanquishes māra, all the gods of the classes of māra, and all the many and varied hosts of māra — subduing them from the very beginning. Once subdued, these very beings go to the Tathāgata for refuge. The Blessed One then teaches them through the three miraculous deeds and through the discipline of the Tathāgata, and they become irreversible with respect to unsurpassable, genuine, and complete awakening.

Such, then, is the sixth quality of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, which abides in the glory of the power of great buddha-might.

Furthermore, the speech of the buddhas, unimpeded, pervades all world-systems without remainder, and in each and every one, being fully recognized by all beings in the world and for the sake of taming sentient

beings, the sound of the Tathāgata is never obstructed by any mountain. It is not impeded by Mount Meru, nor by mountains of jewels, nor by the surrounding ring-mountains great and small, nor by the abodes of gods, the abodes of nāgas, the abodes of yakṣas, the abodes of gandharvas, the abodes of asuras, the abodes of garuḍas, the abodes of kiṃnaras, or the abodes of beings human and non-human. Even if it passes through all world-systems, it clings to none. The great sound of all the world-systems of saṃsāra, and the manifold and fully perfected sounds of every world, are covered over by the sound of the Tathāgata's speech. The ears of those sentient beings who are to be tamed fully perceive it, and what is thus perceived by ear does not lose the clarity of its words and their distinctions. The sound of the Tathāgata is like this: clear, and clearer still, and lucidly resonant. This is the seventh quality of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — the sound of Dharma which abides in the glory of the power of great buddha-might.

Furthermore, the mind of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, purified through inconceivably and inexpressibly many tens of millions of hundreds of thousands of aeons, is free of attachment. It is the adornment of all buddhas of the past, the future, and the present, unstained by any defilement. It abides in all phenomena that are without self. It is neither interior nor exterior. It opens and analyzes in full all undertakings with respect to what is unborn. It is at peace. It has no fixed abode. It is free of all kinds of elaboration.

It is the cessation of perception that is conceptual thought regarding all essences. Its intrinsic nature is luminosity. It is utterly and completely pure. It follows in the wake of all phenomena that are free from affliction, unattached to every undertaking and mental engagement. Pure and free from attachment in the perfection of the real, it has gone to the ultimate limit of revealing the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena. It follows the inexhaustible expanse of the dharmadhātu. With all perceptions, with the limited and the unlimited, with the conditioned and the unconditioned, and with all assertions having ceased, wisdom goes forth and enters into the frontier of the inexhaustible, unattached expanse of the inexpressible ultimate. It is adorned with the ten powers and all phenomena are thoroughly purified. Entering into skillful means, it teaches the many and various phenomena, the multitude of phenomena, and all phenomena without contradiction, undivided across the three times. It has gone beyond the sovereign power of the non-existence of all dharmadhātus, all phenomena, and all phenomena. Mindful of the character of all phenomena in the distinctive treasury of the source of the

sovereignty of all phenomena, and possessed of the sovereignty that moves through all worlds steeped in bewilderment, it does not rest even on a single particle at the uttermost edge of the immeasurable, all-pervasive directions. Abiding firmly and without fluctuation, the view of gnosis reaches to the very limit of all phenomena without exception. All defilements are utterly exhausted and there is no defilement. The mind is fully liberated. Wisdom is fully liberated. Dwelling in supreme non-attachment at the inexhaustible ultimate of perfect, thorough liberation, it constantly abides in perfect equanimity, abiding without attachment to the three times, and within a single moment of mind it fully knows, without remainder, all the mental conduct of the three times.

This is the eighth power: abiding in the glory of the power of great buddha-might of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones.

Furthermore, the body of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is a unity in which the sound of the Dharma and the body are merged into one. It is the completely accomplished body of all buddhas, a body of immeasurable domain, without boundary or center. It is the body that wholly encompasses all worlds. It is the body unstained by the three realms. Recognizing the body of conditioned appearances, it presents to those who call to mind with elevated intention the assembly of blessings. It is a body that is neither false nor deceptive, the perfectly pure body of equality. It is the assembly of the dharmakāya without coming and without going. It is a body that is unconditioned and indestructible. It is the body of the essential nature of the Dharma that has a single defining characteristic and is beyond defining characteristics. It is a body that abides in no domain and abides in no direction. It is the body of all assemblies without remainder. It is the body of the supreme leader of buddhas manifesting in emanations. It is a body of boundless color. All bodies follow in its wake. It is recognized in the variety of bodies. It follows in the mode of the dharmakāya. It is the body that is the treasury of the maṇḍala of the essence of gnosis, appearing in boundless radiance. It has no diverse activities. It is the body that reveals the expanse of all phenomena. It is the assembly of the body that pervades all sentient beings throughout the whole realm of sentient beings in response to their prayers. It is the perfectly pure body that is unmoved and non-conceptual. It is the body differentiated by existence and non-existence, by what is proper and what is improper. Following in accord with the diverse faiths of all sentient beings, it is the body that tames them. It is the body that raises aloft all the rare and

precious qualities, the sources of all jewels, looking upon those to be tamed with subsiding and non-subsiding. It is the body that gathers all phenomena into buddhadharma and suchness. It is the body at the ultimate that is by its very nature supremely at peace and unobscured. It is the body born from all phenomena of non-obstruction. It follows all, and the dharmadhātu is pure.

It is the body that is fully differentiated throughout all worlds, never turning back from what it has undertaken, following in the wake of all the gnosis of liberation of every buddha. It is the body that goes after all that follows. This is the ninth, the dharmakāya of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, gathered together in the glory and power of their great might.

Furthermore, all the Tathāgatas are born from all the practices of bodhisattvas, utterly imbued with the gnosis of equality and the equality of the Blessed Ones, the buddhas. They arise distinctly out of those practices. Their distinctive aspirational prayers, their pure conduct as bodhisattvas, the gnosis that perfectly completes all bodhisattva practices — all the buddhas who are without the diversified activity of conceptualization, born from all bodhisattva practices, knowing the rites of every conduct of the ocean of bodhisattva practices, possessed of great aspiration, and whose conduct is not slight. Not content to see all practices perfectly completed, arising from all practices difficult to bear through the power of conduct, with all practices fully pure. Practicing the excellent practice of bodhisattvas inexhaustibly. Abiding in all immeasurable meditative absorptions of all the buddhas. Teaching all paths within a domain of activity that is boundless. Entering into all paths and all domains that are not the path. Knowing the rites of the power of supreme gnosis. Turning the wheel of Dharma without hesitation. The gnosis of equality and the gnosis that is equal to equality, supremely and perfectly pure in showing the mode of the venerable Dharma whether virtuous conduct is adorned or not adorned — the three kinds of conduct of body, speech, and mind being perfectly pure. Entering into the family of all the Tathāgatas, into the gnosis of the buddhas, and into all their deeds through conduct reached by the gateway not found apart from the buddhas. Abiding in omniscience. Dwelling in the teaching of what is immeasurable. The gnosis of all the supernormal knowledges that has neither root nor limit, being inconceivable. The gnosis that follows along with the minds of the sentient beings of the world. The gnosis that sees all phenomena of absolutely every being throughout every destiny, subtle without remainder, a gnosis without periphery or center. Comprehending through subtle gnosis the modes of

entering all three times. Every world-realm without remainder being completely purified, and the gnosis that includes all world-realms together with what transcends the world — meaning, gnosis, and the deeds of the buddhas being inexpressible — the body of all the buddhas in an irreversible gnosis. Perfectly ascertaining through gnosis that enters into enumeration all phenomena of Dharma without syllables. The gnosis that is inexpressible, diversified and differentiated, that comprehends all syllables as inexpressible. The sequence of the gnosis of Samantabhadra, wherein all phenomena of virtuous conduct in gnosis are completely pure. The gnosis by which all phenomena are thoroughly understood through the gnosis that is endowed with a single moment of mind, in whatever way is fitting. The gnosis that reflects thoroughly on the manner in which one abandons the phenomena of sense sources in the body of every sentient being — not a gnosis whose domain is bounded by the domain of any phenomenon. Following in the wake of absolutely all world-realms, all destinies without remainder, all sentient beings without remainder, all the dharmadhātu without remainder, and the domain seen by the gnosis of non-attachment to a single moment of mind across the three times — entering into the domain in which all Tathāgatas without remainder give rise to buddhahood, and following in the wake of every domain of taming all beings without remainder.

Awakening in complete purity at the boundary of buddha-mind, with direct knowledge and manifest awakening beyond all objects. Comprehending without remainder all the minds and mental consciousnesses of sentient beings. Awakening in the wake of gnosis through each moment of mind divided by the three times, and awakening without interruption. Going without limit to all sentient beings, going without end throughout all world-realms, going without limit throughout all world-realms, going immeasurably throughout all three times, going to all the supreme herds of buddhas, going without remainder to all that is thoroughly realized, manifestly and perfectly awakening from all of those without remainder — following in the wake of all thorough realizations and never relinquishing the gnosis of the buddhas. Abiding in the magical emanations of all buddhas.

Therein: the Blessed One, the buddhas, abiding without boundary or center. The body of the supreme herd of buddhas abiding without boundary or center. Abiding with a mind free from attachment. Abiding engaged in great compassion without boundary or center. Abiding at all times, always uninterruptedly teaching the Dharma. This is the tenth quality of abiding in the

great wisdom — the splendor of the great buddha-power of the Blessed One, the buddhas.

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten qualities of abiding in the splendor of the power of the great buddha-power of the Blessed One, the buddhas — inconceivable and immeasurable to all sentient beings and to all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas of the past, future, and present.

O sons of the Victor, the ten qualities in which the Blessed One, the buddhas, abide — what are the ten? The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide in Tuṣita for as long as they wish and then transfer when their lifespan is exhausted. The Blessed One, the buddhas, display a lifespan of abiding for ten months. The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide with the intention of manifestly going forth and wishing to go forth. The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide at the foot of the awakening tree, manifestly and perfectly awakening through all buddha-qualities. The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide having manifestly and perfectly awakened to all buddha-qualities in a single moment, and display the emanations of all Tathāgatas throughout all world-realms. The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide turning the wheel of Dharma in accordance with the time for taming beings. The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide at the appropriate time displaying and indicating the roots of virtue to be cultivated. The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide at the appropriate time engaged in the deeds of a buddha. The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide giving instruction to perfectly consummate bodhisattvas. The Blessed One, the buddhas, abide giving instruction in a single moment to all questions asked by all sentient beings in that single moment.

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten qualities in which the Blessed One, the buddhas, abide.

O sons of the Victor, the ten qualities of the swift Tathāgata-vision of the Blessed One, the buddhas — what are the ten? The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings heading toward an evil destiny, swiftly turn those beings back.

The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings, swiftly bring it about that their merit goes on to perfect completion. The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings, swiftly bring about the full ripening of their roots of virtue. The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings, swiftly bring it about that they individually attain pure birth in the higher realms. The Blessed One, the

buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings, swiftly draw near to crushing doubt and indecision. The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings who have generated the awakening mind toward awakening, swiftly come to them so as to render them irreversible, and they inspire faith in the vast mind. The Blessed One, the buddhas, bring it about that beings fit to be trained by a buddha who have not yet generated the awakening mind do generate the awakening mind directed toward unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening. The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing those who have entered the womb, regard them as their object of focus and firmly grasp the cause of their entry into the womb. The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings, swiftly bring it about that the faculties of those sentient beings are purified beyond the world. The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings, swiftly come to bring about the exhaustion of all obscurations. The Blessed One, the buddhas, upon immediately seeing sentient beings, swiftly find illumination individually and, being without timidity, begin to arouse confidence in fearlessness.

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten qualities of the swift Tathāgata-vision of the Blessed One, the buddhas.

O sons of the Victor, the ten pure recollections of the self of the Blessed One, the buddhas — what are the ten? The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect the mental conduct of all bodhisattvas. The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect the perfect completion of all the perfections of bodhisattvas. The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect the perfect completion of the great aspirations of bodhisattvas. The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect the accomplishments of bodhisattvas. The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect both their own previous holy life as buddhas and that of bodhisattvas as well. The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect the gateway through which bodhisattvas manifestly and perfectly awaken. The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect the measureless and boundless form bodies of bodhisattvas. The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect the measureless and boundless buddha-fields and emanations, and those of bodhisattvas as well. The Blessed One, the buddhas, recollect the ten powers and the fearlessness of the minds of bodhisattvas.

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten pure recollections of the self of the Blessed One, the buddhas.

O sons of the Victor, the ten abidances of the Tathāgatas in omniscience — what are the ten? They are as follows: knowing the complete and entire expanse of all phenomena; knowing the various minds of all sentient beings of the three times; knowing in a single moment of mind the conduct of a single mind and the turning back of distraction; knowing the actions of all sentient beings of all three times without remainder, along with their various associations with action, their aspects, their sequence,

the growth and accumulation of actions, and the sequence of their subsequent karmic maturation — knowing all of this in a single moment of mind; knowing the entire expanse of the dharmadhātu without remainder, together with the various classes of sentient beings and a single class of sentient beings, and all sentient beings without exception — knowing, at the right time, the miraculous display of taming and teaching sentient beings, the miraculous display of subsequent instruction, and the blessing of miraculous display through supernatural power; knowing the entire dharmadhātu without remainder, all the directions of the vast expanse, all world-systems — having gone to them all, being perceived as a mark by the minds of all sentient beings — and knowing the distinct appearances of the arising of buddhas; knowing the intentions, the faith, and the capacity for training of all sentient beings in all world-systems without remainder, and in a single moment, through a sequence of immeasurable stages, their beholding of buddhas, and knowing the blessing of clear manifestation; knowing how to display, to all sentient beings in all world-systems without remainder, the blessing of the buddhas according to what their minds aspire to from the other side; knowing, through non-grasping at the entire dharmadhātu without remainder, how — just as sentient beings are to be tamed — to guide and subsequently instruct them, coming from the buddhas, and knowing how to display the arising of Tathāgatas; knowing the diligence, in a moment of mind, of going to the entire dharmadhātu without remainder and to all sentient beings — going to each of those various places; knowing, in a single moment of mind, the sending forth and the engagement of the recollection of buddhas in all directions to all sentient beings throughout the entire dharmadhātu without remainder; and knowing, in a single moment of mind, how — in accordance with the immeasurable faith of all sentient beings throughout the entire dharmadhātu without remainder — to display the beholding of the bodies of buddhas and the boundless range of colors of the form bodies.

O sons of the Victor, these are the ten abidances of the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, in omniscience.

O sons of the Victor, the ten immeasurable, inconceivable meditative absorptions (samādhi) of the buddhas — the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — what are the ten? They are as follows:

The Blessed One, the buddha, ever enters into meditative absorption with respect to all phenomena, and in a single moment of mind teaches the Dharma of the entire dharmadhātu without remainder to sentient beings.

The Blessed One, the buddha, enters into meditative absorption with respect to the entire dharmadhātu without remainder, and in a single moment of mind illuminates throughout the sequence of the various elements of sentient beings, which has reached the culmination of selflessness.

The Blessed One, the buddha, enters into meditative absorption with respect to the entire dharmadhātu without remainder and with respect to the three times, abiding in meditative absorption at the very limit of a single moment of mind.

The Blessed One, the buddha, ever enters into meditative absorption with respect to the entire dharmadhātu without remainder — throughout all the vast reaches of innumerable world-systems fine as dust — and with respect to all the families and pure lands of the buddhas, abiding at the inexhaustible limit.

The Blessed One, the buddha, enters into meditative absorption with respect to the entire dharmadhātu without remainder and with respect to the boundless bodies of the buddhas, and in a single moment displays the clear manifestation of the various bodies of buddhas throughout all worlds.

The Blessed One, the buddha, ever enters into meditative absorption with respect to the entire dharmadhātu without remainder and with respect to the complete luminosity of body, speech, and mind, abiding as the treasury of the various minds of all sentient beings, and in a single moment, in accordance with their faith, acts in mind —

The Blessed One, the buddha, ever enters into meditative absorption with respect to the entire dharmadhātu without remainder and with respect to the essential nature of all phenomena, and has arrived at the ultimate end of freedom from attachment; and the Blessed One, the buddha, ever enters into meditative absorption with respect to all of the entire dharmadhātu without

remainder and with respect to the conditions of all worlds, and in a single moment displays the conditions of speech; and the Blessed One, the buddha, ever enters into meditative absorption with respect to all of the entire dharmadhātu without remainder and with respect to all the measureless dust-mote-like worlds both within the world and beyond the world, and in a single moment follows after boundless conditions — whereby the view toward the buddha is unobstructed, and he causes boundless sentient beings and buddhas to be seen; and the Blessed One, the buddha, ever enters into meditative absorption with respect to all of the entire dharmadhātu without remainder, in the mode of non-striving, and in a single moment, having understood and known all the qualities of a buddha, attains the boundless perfections of a buddha's liberation.

O child of the Victors, these are the ten boundless and inconceivable meditative absorptions of the buddhas — the Blessed Ones, the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas.

O child of the Victors, the ten liberations of the Blessed One, the buddhas — what are these ten?

The first is the liberation of displaying the arising of inexpressibly inexpressible buddhas within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote.

The second is the liberation of displaying the turning of an inexpressibly inexpressible wheel of Dharma within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote.

The third is the liberation of displaying the taming and completely ripening of an inexpressibly inexpressible number of sentient beings within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote.

The fourth is the liberation of displaying an inexpressibly inexpressible number of pure lands (buddha-fields) within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote.

The fifth is the liberation of displaying, within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote, the arising of buddhas of the past, the future, and the present.

The sixth is the liberation of displaying, within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote, the passing away of buddhas of the past, the future, and the present.

The seventh is the liberation of displaying, within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote, the miraculous powers and emanations of all Tathāgatas of the past, the future, and the present.

The eighth is the liberation of displaying, within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote, the teaching of Dharma to sentient beings by buddhas of the past, the future, and the present.

The ninth is the liberation of displaying, within a single exceedingly subtle dust-mote, the major marks of all buddhas of the past, the future, and the present.

O child of the Victors, these are the ten liberations of the Blessed One, the buddhas.

This completes the twenty-ninth chapter, the chapter on the inconceivable qualities of the buddhas, from the hundred-thousand-section sūtra known as the Great Extensive Ornament of the Ear.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "ten-fold conduct free from attachment and free from obstruction" translates a somewhat compressed Tibetan construction. The "ten" likely refers to a set of ten kinds of unattached, unobstructed conduct associated with advanced bodhisattva practice, though the precise enumeration is not spelled out here in the text.

The expression "knowing exclusively, one after another, the lineage of all the buddhas" renders a terse phrase about recognizing the buddha-lineage in unbroken succession; the exact doctrinal referent may depend on the broader sūtra context.

The name Utpalahṛdaya means "Heart of the Utpala Lotus" and Padmahṛdaya means "Heart of the Lotus"; both are kept in Sanskrit reconstruction as proper names of bodhisattvas addressed in this sūtra.

- The term rendered "sense base of the nose" translates a compound referring to the nasal āyatana. The claim that this yields "supreme dominion over all buddhas" is unusual and may reflect a specialized tantric or Avataṃsaka-register meaning in which the unbounded olfactory faculty symbolizes a penetrating, all-encompassing sovereignty; the Tibetan reads straightforwardly and no emendation has been made.
- The phrase rendered "the ripening — the karmic maturation of perfectly virtuous ripening" reflects a doubled form in the Tibetan ("yang dag pa'i dge ba'i rnam par smin pa'i rnam par smin pa") that appears redundant. This may be a scribal dittography, or it may deliberately distinguish the process of virtuous maturation from its result. The translation preserves the structure without emending.

The phrase "supreme among the noble ones" renders "khyu mchog," literally "the best of the herd," a standard epithet meaning foremost or supreme, often applied to the Buddha as the greatest of beings. It is attached here to the Tathāgata's omniscience.

- The phrase rendered as "supreme and utterly difficult-to-bear excellences" translates the compound 至極難於堪受之至善, where 至善 means a pinnacle or supreme excellence and 難於堪受 literally means "hard to endure" or "hard to bear," signifying qualities so magnificent they exceed ordinary comprehension. Some translators render this as "marvelous" or "wondrous"; the sense is of qualities that overwhelm ordinary capacity to withstand or comprehend.

The phrase རྒྱུ་ལྡན་པའི་ལྷན་པ་ལྟར་ལྷན་པ་ is somewhat idiomatic: རྒྱུ་ལྡན་པའི་ལྷན་པ་ suggests adversaries lurking close or ambushing from one side, while ལྷན་པ་ལྟར་ལྷན་པ་ refers to opponents who attack from the far side or openly. The translation reflects this dual sense of adversaries from both flanks.

- The phrase rendered "four kinds of precise knowledge" translates so so yang dag par rig pa bzhi, corresponding to the Sanskrit catasraḥ pratisaṃvids, the four analytical knowledges or discriminating awarenesses, a standard Mahāyāna category. The Tibetan here is treated as a list element within a larger enumerative passage, and the translation preserves that structure.

The passage about dust-particles and pores is notably complex cosmologically. The image is that a single hair-pore of the buddha's body contains as many subtle particles as all elements of the body together, and from each such pore buddhas emerge in a number equal to all dust-particles of all world-realms. This reading follows the grammar of the Tibetan closely; the exact cosmological mechanics are traditionally elucidated in Avataṃsaka-style commentaries.

The final lines of the passage are syntactically incomplete in the source as given, ending mid-sentence with the introduction of the inexhaustible merit — this is a continuation marker and the translation preserves the open construction accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "cause all sentient beings to emerge from the aggregates" translates a compressed expression meaning the buddhas lead beings to transcend or be liberated from the psycho-physical aggregates; this is the standard soteriological reading in the commentarial tradition.

The list of ten utter purities contains two entries both rendered "utter purity of the dharmakāya." The Tibetan text as given does appear to repeat this entry; this may reflect a scribal duplication in the source, or the two occurrences may intend distinct aspects of the dharmakāya. The translation preserves the text as given.

- The phrase rendered "radiant colors" for རྩམས་པ་ is literally "colors" or "complexion," which in the context of buddha qualities likely refers to the radiant physical hues of a buddha's form, a recognized topic in the catalogues of buddha excellence. The passage ends mid-sentence as given in the source; the translation preserves this open ending accordingly.

- The phrase rendered as "grasping" and "non-grasping" translates "gzung bas" and "mi 'dzin pas" respectively. These are a deliberately paired set of modes through which buddhas nevertheless accomplish buddha-activity; the doctrinal point is that both apprehension of objects and the relinquishment of apprehension can serve as vehicles of buddha-activity. This is a consequential interpretive choice worth flagging.

The phrase "objects that arise by virtue of objects, by means of their blessing" renders a dense construction literally: all sensory objects that come into contact with beings are suffused with buddha-blessing and thus serve as vehicles of buddha-activity. The translation preserves the structure while allowing the sense to emerge.

- The phrase rendered "the former limit of time and the latter limit of time" refers to the infinite past and infinite future, a standard Avataṃsaka formulation for the entirety of time. The sentence is left open as the Tibetan passage breaks off mid-enumeration; the translation faithfully reproduces this.

The fifth essential quality presents a philosophically dense formulation. The Tibetan states that a Tathāgata "neither has arisen nor has not arisen," which in context means the buddha-nature transcends ordinary categories of arising and non-arising, yet the bodhicitta generated on the path remains unbroken throughout until full awakening.

- The phrase rendered "free from any bounded joy" at the end of the light-adornment section translates a somewhat compressed construction meaning that the arising of such luminous

buddha-activity is spontaneous and transcends any limited or partial delight — it is joy without a fixed locus or object. The precise nuance is slightly uncertain and commentators vary; the rendering given is consistent with the doctrinal context of non-attachment throughout the passage.

The "three miracles" refers to the standard Buddhist triad of the miracle of physical transformation, the miracle of mind-reading, and the miracle of instruction — the three types of miraculous display attributed to buddhas and great masters.

- The phrase rendered "treasury-chambers of the maṇḍala of this light are like open halls" is a compressed and somewhat unusual image. The Tibetan reads that all the storage-rooms or receptacles of the light-maṇḍala have become like open houses or halls, suggesting the light is entirely uncontained and freely accessible.

The term translated "color" throughout the color-adornment section renders the Tibetan *kha dog*, which literally means color or complexion. In the context of describing a buddha's bodily radiance, it encompasses the full luminous appearance and hue of the buddha's form.

The phrase "equality and non-equality of all phenomena in their suchness" reflects a standard doctrinal formulation in which a buddha perceives both the sameness of all dharmas in their ultimate nature and the distinctions among them on the conventional level, without contradiction.

- The phrase rendered "magnificence and splendor" translates the Tibetan *lhab lhub*, an onomatopoeic term indicating a resplendent, blazing, or fluttering magnificence; the precise nuance is contextually interpreted here as brilliant display or radiant splendor.

The sixth quality's syntax is dense and compressed. The phrase "the ocean of transformations of the world-systems of the ten directions — every last particle of them" attempts to render a grammatically complex construction linking the world-systems, their transformations, their particles, and the dharmadhātu as objects of the blessing activity.

The seventh quality, beginning "By sovereign lordship, in a single moment of mind," presents a notably paradoxical formulation: the buddha's sovereign activity is described by a series of negations — no one has awakened thus, is awakening thus, or will awaken thus. This appears to express the non-conceptual, non-locatable nature of buddha-activity from within sovereign lordship, and may be a deliberate doctrinal statement about awakening transcending temporal categories. This is a consequential interpretive point that commentators would need to address.

- The phrase rendered "essence of sentient beings" translates རྒྱལ་བ་སྤྲུང་བའི་རྩ་བོ།, which could alternatively be read as "the heart of sentient beings" or even as a reference to buddha-nature within sentient beings. The doctrinal context — each being blessed in every mind-moment — supports a tathāgatagarbha reading, but the text does not make this explicit, so the more literal "essence of sentient beings" is retained.
- The passage contains a recurrent phrase rendered as "beyond number, beyond telling, and beyond all further telling" which translates a compressed superlative idiom for the ineffably vast; the exact enumeration of these intensifying negatives varies slightly in the Tibetan and presents a minor textual difficulty that does not affect the overall sense. The phrase "hundredfold merit" refers to the traditional doctrine that each of the thirty-two major marks of a great being is produced by the perfection of one hundred merits, a standard Abhidharma and Mahāyāna teaching. The passage ends mid-sentence as it was provided; the translation preserves that open ending accordingly.
- The phrase rendered as "phenomena in their raw immediacy" translates the term that literally means "raw" or "primordial" phenomena, which in this context appears to indicate

phenomena as they are prior to conceptual elaboration or narrative overlay. The precise doctrinal referent is debated in commentarial sources, and the translation attempts to convey the sense of phenomena in an unprocessed, immediate state.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, which is a continuation; the translation breaks off accordingly.

- The term གཏུན་མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་ is the Tibetan rendering of Sanskrit pratisaṃvid, the four "analytical wisdoms" or "discriminating knowledges" of a buddha. The text applies multiple qualifying adjectives to it in succession, which creates the extended list translated here. The rendering "analytical wisdom" is standard in the Mahāyāna scholastic tradition.

The final sentence of the passage is syntactically incomplete in the source, breaking off mid-enumeration, consistent with the continuation signal indicated by the preceding passage note. No meaning has been supplied beyond what the Tibetan text contains.

- The phrase rendered "the three assemblies" translates "གཏུན་མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་" followed by four terms: "མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་," "མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་," "མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་," and again "མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་." The repetition of "མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་" in the Tibetan appears to be a scribal error or textual anomaly; the standard grouping in Yogācāra literature is "the three-fold assembly" of the definitely placed, the wrongly placed, and the indefinitely placed, so the second "མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་" likely stands in for a missing fourth term or is a dittograph.

The phrase "མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་" is contextually rendered as "the great treasury of finest garments and great ornaments." The term "མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་" denotes a top-quality outer garment or canopy; the precise referent in this cosmological-biographical enumeration of a buddha's deeds is not entirely certain.

- The phrase rendered "abiding in that which is unborn from a mother" translates "ma las skyes pa de la gnas pas," where "ma las skyes pa" literally means "that which is not born from a mother." This is a technical expression pointing to the unborn, primordially pure nature of reality — the dharmakāya — in which the bodhisattva or buddha abides. The doctrinal point is significant: it contrasts birth from a womb with the unborn ground of awakening.

The phrase "from this ground to the second" is somewhat compressed in the source. It appears to refer to a span between one ground or level and the next, with the blessing pervading everything across that interval before demonstrating knowledge of the number of worlds. The exact referent of "the second" is not entirely transparent from context alone.

- The phrase rendered "rays of light" for གཏུན་མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་ covers what may be specifically "rays of light" or possibly a more technical term for the halos or aureoles surrounding a buddha's form. The two occurrences — "abiding in the midst of immeasurable rays of light" and "adorned with ornaments of immeasurable rays of light" — are both readings of གཏུན་མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་, which most naturally refers to luminous rays. No consequential doctrinal ambiguity arises from this reading.

The phrase གཏུན་མཁྱེན་ལྔ་པ་ is rendered "worlds without a lord," meaning worlds that lack a presiding deity or sovereign. Some editions may read this differently; the sense here is worlds beyond the jurisdiction of any cosmic ruler.

- The phrase rendered "moving in pursuit of the aim of wisdom that ranges freely across the domain of omniscience" translates a dense compound involving "following after" the object of wisdom that sports in the domain of omniscience; the rendering preserves the doctrinal sense without resolving into over-interpretation.

"Adorned thrones shining forth" refers to the bejeweled lion-thrones prepared beneath the tree of awakening in each world-realm, a standard cosmological detail in this genre of text.

- The passage lists a series of non-Buddhist cosmological beings whose palaces the buddhas enter: gandharvas (dri za), asuras (lha ma yin), garuḍas (nam mkha' lding), kinnaras (mi'am ci),

mahoragas (lto 'phyen chen po), a category rendered "those who blaze" (bar ba, possibly a class of spirits or a variant name), and rākṣasas (sha za). The list is conventional in Mahāyāna literature and the identifications are standard.

The phrase rendered "white dharmas" follows a well-attested Mahāyāna idiom for wholesome or pure qualities; the Tibetan dkar po'i chos is the standard equivalent of Sanskrit śukladharma.

The phrase "Tathāgatas who are of boundless and infinite color" is grammatically unusual and may refer to the boundless and varied form-manifestations of Tathāgatas; the doctrinal meaning is that buddhas appear in limitless physical manifestations of every hue to benefit beings.

- The phrase rendered "those who blaze with fire" translates "sangś rgyas 'bar ba," literally "blazing buddhas" or "buddhas among the blazing ones." In context, this appears in a list of classes of beings such as gods, nāgas, garuḍas, and kiṃnaras, and "blazing" here likely refers to a class of fiery or luminous beings, possibly a variety of deity or spirit. The precise identification of this class is uncertain; the translation renders it descriptively rather than imposing a specific Sanskrit equivalent.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, as it is a continuous enumeration; the translation preserves this open ending faithfully.

- The phrase rendered "the one of great compassion" and "the one of loving heart" distinguish two epithets: thugs rje chen po (great compassion) and thugs brtse ba (loving heart or affectionate mind). These are kept distinct as separate epithets in the lament sequence, which is a formulaic list of the Buddha's qualities eulogized at his passing.

The phrase "resting in conceptual thought while causing the light of gnosis to appear" renders rtog pa la gnas shing ye shes snang bar gyur pa, which is deliberately paradoxical: the buddha, though abiding amid the conceptual thought-world of beings, simultaneously manifests gnosis. This tension is intentional and doctrinal, not a scribal error.

The list at the close is the opening of a longer enumeration of beings that continues in the following passage; it breaks off mid-sentence in the source.

- The phrase rendered "the field of giving in which merit does not abide" reflects the Mahāyāna idea that the accumulation of merit through veneration of the buddhas after their nirvāṇa continues to function as a "field of giving" even though no personal merit-deposit accrues to a self — the merit is, as it were, transferred or dedicated rather than retained. This is a genuine doctrinal subtlety rather than a translation ambiguity.

The final sentence introduces a new enumeration that continues beyond this passage; only the opening formula and the first item are given here.

- The phrase rendered "the following of all the buddha-fields of the buddhas of the three times and the following of the field of a single buddha" contains the Tibetan rjes su 'gro ba, literally "following after" or "coursing through," used here in the sense of the wisdom that encompasses or permeates buddha-fields. The precise meaning is somewhat compressed in the original.

The phrase "not regarding the Tathāgatas as beings of equal fortune" translates skal ba mnyam pa ma yin par gnas pa. This likely indicates that the buddhas abide in the recognition that sentient beings do not all share equal karmic fortune, i.e., they do not treat all beings as if equally receptive — a point about skillful means. This interpretation is doctrinally plausible but the clause is elliptical.

The closing image of a "master illusionist elaborating forms" renders mig 'phrul mkhan gyis rnam par phyen ba ltar, literally "like one who divides or lays out by means of an eye-illusion maker," i.e., a conjurer who creates visual illusions. The passage ends mid-enumeration, as the

source text continues beyond the excerpt provided.

- The passage lists a sequence of being-types in the cosmos — gandharvas, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, and so forth — that are standard in the Avataṃsaka sūtra's cosmological registers. The Tibetan terms used are standard and the identifications are certain; no further gloss seemed necessary in the body beyond what the house glossary provides.

The phrase rendered "the faculty of life cannot be cut short" translates a term for the vital faculty or life-force that is inviolable. The contrast being drawn throughout this passage is between the supreme invulnerability of the buddha-body and every conceivable force in the cosmos, which is the doctrinal point the passage is making about the first of the ten qualities of the buddhas' great power.

- The phrase rendered as "infinitely infinite subtlest dust-particles of the inexpressible, yet-again-inexpressible buddha-fields" reflects a formulaic Tibetan hyperbolic construction using double inexpressibility, a standard Avataṃsaka-style amplification indicating quantities utterly beyond enumeration. The repetition is intentional and doctrinal, not a scribal error.

The passage on the Tathāgata holding all beings at the tip of a finger while simultaneously moving through all space and remaining seated in a single cross-legged posture is a deliberate paradox illustrating the non-dual, unimpeded nature of a buddha's activity-body — consistent with the Avataṃsaka teaching that a buddha's conduct encompasses all spatial and temporal extremes without contradiction or effort.

- The image of the "calf of the glory of the enlightened mind" at the very end is an unusual metaphor. The Tibetan "thugs dpal gyi be'u" literally means "calf of the glory of the mind," likely evoking a rich, inexhaustible stream of nourishment flowing from that "calf" — possibly a metaphor drawn from the image of a suckling calf and the continuous flow of milk, symbolizing the inexhaustible outpouring of the Buddha's wisdom mind. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at this point.

The "firebrand wheel" refers to a torch whirled rapidly in a circle, creating the appearance of an unbroken wheel of fire — a classical Indian simile for the continuous, uninterrupted activity of all phenomena without fixed essence.

- The phrase rendered "the three miraculous deeds" refers to the traditional triad of miraculous displays by which the Tathāgata tames beings: the miracle of physical transformation, the miracle of mind-reading, and the miracle of teaching — a standard formulation in this literature.

The final three sound-epithets rendered as "clear, and clearer still, and lucidly resonant" translate the three Tibetan sound-ideophonic particles lham me, lhan ne, and lhang nge, which evoke progressively vivid auditory clarity. These are phonaesthetic particles resisting direct equivalence; the rendering attempts to convey their graduated, sensory resonance.

- The passage contains several highly compressed and syntactically challenging strings, particularly in the middle section describing the dharmadhātu and its relationship to gnosis. The phrase rendered as "the source of the sovereignty of all phenomena" involves an unusually dense genitive chain that may alternatively be read as describing a treasury or storehouse of all phenomenal qualities. The line about "moving through all worlds steeped in bewilderment" is literally about the power or sovereignty that travels through bewildered worlds, and is rendered accordingly. The final list of body-qualities is elliptical throughout; each phrase functions as a predicate applied to the buddha-body, and the translation renders them as such for clarity and flow.

- The passage is a dense enumeration of attributes of gnosis and conduct, characteristic of the late-canonical cataloguing style found in texts such as the Avataṃsaka corpus. The phrase rendered "not content to see all practices perfectly completed" translates a construction that

could alternatively mean "not rejoicing in the perfect completion of all practices" in the sense of never resting satisfied; the chosen rendering preserves both senses. The phrase "gateway not found apart from the buddhas" renders a construction meaning the uniquely buddhic mode of access, contrasting with paths available to others. The passage on "virtuous conduct adorned or not adorned" refers to the gnosis of equality that operates uniformly regardless of whether beings' conduct meets or falls short of the ideal.

- The phrase "supreme herd of buddhas" renders རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷན་སྐྱེས་པའི་སྐུ་ལྷན་, where རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷན་ literally means "supreme herd" or "supreme flock," a somewhat unusual collective epithet for buddhas that has no single transparent Sanskrit equivalent; it is rendered literally in keeping with the stylized enumerative register of the Avataṃsaka literature from which this passage derives.

The reference to the Blessed One abiding in Tuṣita for a fixed period and then "transferring" reflects the standard Mahāyāna biography in which a future buddha dwells in Tuṣita heaven before descending to take birth; "abiding for ten months" refers to the period of gestation in the mother's womb, a standard biographical element in this literary genre.

- The phrase rendered "pure recollections of the self" translates a construction that is doctrinally unusual, as it appears to refer to the Buddha's own self-awareness or introspective recollection of his qualities and those of bodhisattvas. The term "self" here carries no atmanist implication; it is the reflexive or personal sense, meaning "his own" recollections.

The phrase rendered "those who have entered the womb" refers to beings at the moment of conception or gestation, and the Buddha's "object of focus" and "cause of entry into the womb" pertain to his compassionate attention to the circumstances of beings taking rebirth.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, as it continues into the following portion.

- The phrase rendered "innumerable world-systems fine as dust" translates a compound that literally reads "all the vast reaches of all directions of the entire dharmadhātu without remainder, without ten atoms" — the "འཁོར་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" element is unusual and may be a scribal or print corruption. It most likely intends something like "innumerable as atomized worlds," and the translation conveys that sense. This is a genuinely uncertain reading worth flagging.

- The title rendered at the close, "Great Extensive Ornament of the Ear," is a literal rendering of the Tibetan Snyan gyi gong rgyan rgyas pa chen po'i mdo. This appears to be a less-familiar sūtra title; the Tibetan is rendered faithfully here, though the Sanskrit equivalent is not securely attested and no reconstruction is offered.

The enumeration of liberations in this passage lists only nine items explicitly, yet the text's concluding summary declares them to be ten. This discrepancy is present in the Tibetan as given; a tenth liberation may be missing from the transmitted passage or was covered in the preceding passage.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.